

SAMIKSHA TEST 1 - SOLUTION

Q1. Arrange the following Indus Valley sites from north to south:

1. Nageshwar
2. Kotdiji
3. Mitathal
4. Dholavira

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- A. 1-2-3-4
- B. 2-3-4-1
- C. 3-2-4-1
- D. 4-3-2-1

Answer: C

Explanation:

Indus Valley sites:

- **Nageshwar:** Located in Kutch district, Gujarat
 - Shell working site.
- **Dholavira:** Located at Khadir bet in Kutch district, Gujarat
 - Lies on Tropic of Cancer
 - UNESCO world heritage site
- **Mitathal:** Located in Bhiwani in Haryana
 - Dates to Sothi-Siswal phase of Indus Valley Civilization.
- **Kotdiji:** Located on the bank of Indus River in Sindh, Pakistan.



Hence, option C is correct.

Q2. Consider the following statements regarding Early Vedic period:

1. Cattle rearing was the most important economic activity.
2. The early Vedic society was a simple and largely an egalitarian society.
3. The institution of gotra developed in this period.

How many of the above statements is/are correct?

- A. Only one
- B. Only two
- C. All three
- D. None

Answer: B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The early Vedic Aryans were pastoralists. **Cattle rearing** was their main occupation. They reared cattle, sheep, goats, and horses for purposes of milk, meat and hides.
- A large number of words are derived from the word **go** meaning cow. A **wealthy person** was known as **gomat** and the **daughter** called **duhitri** which means one who milks the cow. The cows were thought of as providers of everything. Prayers are offered for increase in the number of cattle.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The family was the basic unit of the Rigvedic society. It was patriarchal in nature. The family was part of a larger grouping called vis or clan. One or more than one clan made jana or tribe. The **Rigvedic society was a simple and largely an egalitarian society**. There was **no caste division**. **Occupation was not based on birth**. Members of a family could adopt different occupations.
- **Statement 3 is not correct:** The **institution of gotra developed in later vedic period** (not in **early vedic**). This means that people having common gotra descended from a common ancestor and no marriage between the members of the same gotra could take place.

Hence, option B is correct.

Q3. Consider the following statements regarding Amravati school of art:

1. It flourished in the region of Andhra Pradesh between the lower valleys of rivers Krishna and Godavari.
2. The Amravati artists used local red sandstone with black spots to make the images.
3. Amravati, Nagarjunikonda, Ghantasala and Vengi were the prominent places associated with this school of art.

How many of the above statements is/are correct?

- A. Only one
- B. Only two
- C. All three
- D. None

Answer: B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Amravati school of art flourished in the region of Andhra Pradesh between the lower valleys of rivers Krishna and Godavari. The main patrons of this art form were the **Satavahanas** and later by **Ikshavaku**.
- **Statement 2 is not correct:** The Amravati artists used **white marble** like stone to carve out the figures. An important characteristic of the Amravati school is the 'narrative art'. The medallions were carved in such a manner that they depict an incident in a natural way. For

example, one medallion depicts a whole story of 'taming of an elephant by the Buddha'. **Red sandstone** was used in **Mathura** school of art.

- **Statement 3 is correct:** Prominent places where this style developed are **Amravati, Nagarjunikonda, Goli, Ghantasala** and **Vengi**. Both religious and secular images were present in this style.

Hence, option B is correct.

Q4. Consider the following pairs:

<i>Historical place</i>	<i>Well-known for</i>
1. Burzahom	Rock-cut shrines
2. Chandra ketugarh	Terracotta art
3. Ganeshwar	Copper artefacts
4. Barhut	Stupa

How many of the above given pairs is/are correctly matched?

- A. Only one
- B. Only two
- C. Only three
- D. All four

Answer: C

Explanation:

- **Pair 1 is not correct:** Pits have been found at neolithic levels at **Burzahom**. Burzahom had a well-developed bone tool industry; artefacts such as points, harpoons, needles etc. The site is famous for pit dwelling and neolithic tool industry. Rock cut shrines were not found in Neolithic period.
- **Pair 2 is correct:** **Chandra-ketugarh** was a major centre of **terracotta craft**. Chandraketugarh is a site in **West Bengal** near Kolkata.
- **Pair 3 is correct:** The **Ganeshwar-Jodhpura** culture was located in the north-eastern part of **Rajasthan**. It is located in Khetri belt. Hundreds of **copper objects** found at this site suggest that it had emerged as a copper-working center.
- **Pair 4 is correct:** **Bharhut** is a village located in the Satna district of Madhya Pradesh, central India. It is known for its famous **relics from a Buddhist stupa**.

Hence, option C is correct.

Q5. With reference to Sikhism, consider the following statements:

1. Guru Nanak Dev did not intend to establish a new religion.
2. Guru Gobind Singh compiled Guru Nanak's hymns in the Adi Granth Sahib.
3. Guru Nanak Dev was the contemporary of Babur.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** **Guru Nanak Dev did not intend to establish a new religion.** He was a Nirgun saint. He believed in **oneness of God** (Ek Onkar "Ek" is One and "Onkar" is God). He is the same God for all people of all religions. He believed people should remember God in everything they do which is called 'simran'. After his death, his followers established a new religion, called as Sikhism.
- **Statement 2 is not correct:** Guru Gobind Singh compiled the Adi Granth Sahib, but it was **Guru Arjan Dev** (the fifth Sikh Guru) who compiled the **hymns of Guru Nanak and other Gurus into the Adi Granth Sahib**. Guru Gobind Singh affirmed the scripture's authority and added the compositions of the ninth Sikh Guru, Guru Tegh Bahadur, to the Adi Granth Sahib. It was then called as **Guru Granth Sahib**.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Guru Nanak Dev was born in 1469 in Talwandi, Pakistan. Babur was born in 1483 and ruled India for 4 years (1526-1530). So, Guru Nanak Dev and Babur were indeed contemporaries, and their lives overlapped during the early 16th century.

Hence, option C is correct.

Q6. Consider the following statements with reference to Indus Valley Civilization:

1. Dholavira is the only site divided into 3 parts- upper, middle and lower.
2. Chanhudaro is the only urban site without a citadel.
3. Alamgirpur is the only Indus Valley Civilization site in Uttar Pradesh.

How many of the above statement/s is/are correct?

- A. Only one
- B. Only two
- C. All three
- D. None

Answer: B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** **Dholavira** is the **only site divided into 3 parts-** upper, middle and lower. It is the **fifth largest site of Indus valley civilization** located on Khadir bet Island.

- **Statement 2 is correct:** Chanhudaro is the **only urban site without a citadel**. It is situated in Sindh on the banks of **Indus River**.
- **Statement 3 is not correct:** Alamgirpur is the **not the only** Indus Valley Civilization site in Uttar Pradesh. Other sites in Uttar Pradesh are: **Sadikpur-Sanauli, Bargaon, Hulas**.

Hence, option B is correct.

Q7. With reference to medieval history of India, “Chahar Taslim” refers to:

- A. Mode of salutation
- B. Prayer hall
- C. Style of Writing
- D. Type of painting in Mughal age

Answer: A

Explanation:

- **Chahar taslim** is a **mode of salutation** which begins with placing the back of the right hand on the ground, and raising it gently till the person stands erect, when he puts the palm of his hand upon the crown of his head. It is done **four (chahar) times**. Taslim literally means **submission**.
- The forms of salutation to the ruler indicated the person’s status in the hierarchy. Deeper prostration represented higher status.
- The **highest form of submission** was **sijda** or **complete prostration**. Under Shah Jahan, these rituals were replaced with **chahar taslim** and **zaminbos** (kissing the ground).

Hence, option A is correct.

Q8. Which of the following rulers of Medieval India has composed a work on state craft known as the ‘Amuktamalyada’?

- A. Harihar
- B. Bukka
- C. Deva Raya II
- D. Krishna Deva Raya

Answer: D

Explanation:

- **Krishna Deva Raya** was one of the greatest King of the Vijayanagara empire. His empire extended from the **river Krishna in the north to river Cauvery in the south**; the Arabian Sea in the west to Bay of Bengal in the east.
- His important works are:
 - Amuktamalyada (telugu work on polity)
 - Jambavati Kalyanam (Sanskrit drama)
 - Ushaparinayam

- He was a **great builder** of his times. He built new city called **Nagalapuram** in memory of his mother queen Nagaladevi.

Hence, option D is correct.

Q9. Which of the following are the features of the bhakti movement?

1. Nirguna Bhakti saints preached the principles of monotheism.
2. They advocated that the salvation could be attained only by deep devotion and faith in God.
3. They considered the Sanskrit language as sacred language.

How many of the above statements is/are correct?

- A. Only one
- B. Only two
- C. Only three
- D. None

Answer: B

Explanation:

Salient Features of Bhakti Movement are as follows:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Nirguna Bhakti saints preached the **principles of monotheism** (oneness of God). Nirguna saints believed that god has no definite form and attributes.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** They advocated that the salvation could be attained only by deep devotion and faith in God. They condemned ritualism, pilgrimage and fasts.
- Bhakti saints preached the **equality of all beings in the eyes of God**. They advocated for a **more inclusive and egalitarian approach**, challenging social hierarchies and discrimination based on birth.
- **Statement 3 is not correct:** They **did not consider any language as sacred** and composed poems in the language of the common people. This made the teachings of the Bhakti saints accessible to a broader audience, transcending linguistic barriers.

Hence, option B is correct.

Q10. Who among the following has described the medieval Indian postal system as of two Kinds i.e. the horse-post called 'Uluq' and the foot-post called 'Dawa'?

- A. Al-Biruni
- B. Duarte Barbosa
- C. Ibn Battuta
- D. Seydi Ali Reis

Answer: C

Explanation:

- **Ibn Battuta** explains the **postal system**. He was a Moroccan scholar and explorer who explored the medieval world extensively.

- The **horse post** known as **Uluq** is run by royal horses posted **every four miles apart**.
- The **foot post** has **three stations per mile**, **one third of mile** is named as **Dawa**.

Hence, option C is correct.

Q11. With reference to the Sangam Literature, consider the following pairs:

<i>Work</i>	<i>Author</i>
1. Silappadikaram	Seetalai Sattanar
2. Manimegalai	Illango Adigal
3. Tolkappiyam	Tolkappiyar
4. Kundalakesi	Nathakuthanaar

How many of the above pairs are correctly matched?

- A. Only one
- B. Only two
- C. Only three
- D. All four

Answer: B

Explanation:

- **Pair 1 is not correct:** **Silappadikaram** was composed by **Illango Adigal**, describes the story of Kovalan and Kannagi. It gives insight into contemporary Tamil society, polity and social life of the people. It is called the Iliad of Tamil Literature.
- **Pair 2 is not correct:** **Manimegalai** was composed by **Seetalai Sattanar**. It was a sequel to Silappadikaram, where Manimekhlai is the daughter of Kovalan, born to Madhavi. It contains useful details about the Sangam government and society. It is called as the Odissi of Tamil literature.
- **Pair 3 is correct:** **Tolkappiyam** was written by **Tolkappiyar** and consider the first Tamil literary work. It also gives an insight into the political and socio-economic conditions of the time.
- **Pair 4 is correct:** **Kundalakesi** was authored by **Nathakuthanaar**. It is related to Buddhism.

Hence, option B is correct.

Q12. Which of the following causes contributed to the decline of the Mughals?

1. Presence of a definite law of succession
2. Corrupt and inefficient bureaucracy
3. Aurangzeb's religious policy
4. Invasions of Irani and Durrani kingdoms

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2, 3 and 4 only
- C. 1, 3 and 4 only
- D. 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: B

Explanation:

Causes which contributed to the decline of the Mughals were as follows:

- **Statement 1 is not correct:** With the **absence of a definite law of succession**, there always occurred a **war of succession**; this weakened the stability of the government.
- The **deterioration of the army** also proved disastrous for the empire.
- The later Mughals were not efficient and neglected the administration of the state.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Over time, the Mughal administrative system became **corrupt and inefficient**. The bureaucracy became increasingly corrupt, with officials engaging in bribery and extortion. This weakened the governance and revenue collection systems.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** **Aurangzeb's religious policy** was largely responsible, leading to revolts by Rajputs, Sikhs, Jats and Marathas.
- **Aurangzeb's Deccan policy** was a failure and was an important cause of the downfall of the Mughal empire.
- **Statement 4 is correct:** **Invasions of Irani and Durrani kingdoms** gave a death-blow to the Mughal empire.

Hence, option B is correct.

Q13. Consider the following statements regarding Religion in Vedic period:

1. The Later vedic gods were personifications of different aspects of natural forces such as rain, storm, sun etc.
2. There were no female gods present in Early Vedic period.
3. There was increase in the frequency and number of the yajna in Later Vedic period.

How many of the above statements is/are **NOT** correct?

- A. Only one
- B. Only two
- C. All three

D. None

Answer: B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is not correct:** The Rigvedic gods were generally personifications of different aspects of natural forces such as rains, storm, sun etc. The prayers to propitiate gods for physical protection and for material gains were the main concerns of the Rigvedic people.
- **Statement 2 is not correct:** Indra, Agni, Varuna, Mitra, Dyaus, Pushana, Yama, Soma, etc. are all **male gods**. In comparison, we have **only a few goddesses** such as Ushas, Sarasvati, Prithvi, Aditi etc which occupy secondary positions in the pantheon.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** There was **increase in the frequency and number of the yajna in later vedic period** which generally ended with the sacrifices of a large number of animals. This was probably the **result of the growing importance of a class of brahmanas** and their efforts to maintain their supremacy in the changing society. These yajnas brought to them a large amount of wealth in form of dana and dakshina. Some of the important yajnas were - **Ashvamedha, Vajapeya, Rajasuya** etc.

Hence, option B is correct.

Q14. With reference to Kushanas, consider the following statements:

1. Kanishka convened the fourth Buddhist council at Kundalvan in Kashmir.
2. Kushana kings took the title of Devaputra i.e. son of God.
3. Both Ashvaghosha and Charaka were contemporary of Kanishka.

Which of the above statement/s is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 1 and 2 only
- C. 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Kanishka is famous in history as a **great patron of Buddhism**. He convened the **fourth Buddhist Council** at **Kundalavana** (present day Harwan near Srinagar in Jammu and Kashmir) in which a large number of Buddhist scholars took part. It was in this council that Buddhism got split into two schools – Hinayana and Mahayana.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** A prominent feature of Kushana polity was the **title of devaputra**, i.e. **son of God, used by the Kushana kings**. It indicates the claim to divinity by the Kushana kings.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Charaka, known as **father of Ayurveda**, wrote a book on medicine called **Charaksamhita** whereas **Ashvaghosha**, a Buddhist scholar, wrote **Buddhacharita**, a **full-length biography of the Buddha**. Both these scholars were believed to be the **contemporaries of king Kanishka**.

Hence, option D is correct.

Q15. Consider the following statements regarding Dholavira:

1. It is located on Khadir bet and lies on tropic of cancer.
2. It is situated on the bank of Sabarmati River.
3. It was famous for its water management system.
4. It was declared as world heritage site by UNESCO.

How many of the above statements is/are correct?

- A. Only one
- B. Only two
- C. Only three
- D. All four

Answer: C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** It is located on Khadir bet (Island) in Gujarat. It was discovered by RS Bisht in 1985. Also, it lies on Tropic of cancer.
- **Statement 2 is not correct:** It lies on the banks of **Luni River**.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** It was famous for its water management system, multilayered defensive mechanisms, extensive use of stone in construction and special burial structures. The site has a **fortified citadel, a middle town and a lower town** with walls made of **sandstone or limestone** instead of mud bricks in many other Harappan sites.
- **Statement 4 is correct:** It was declared a **UNESCO world heritage site** in **2021**. While Dholavira became the **fourth site from Gujarat** and **40th from India** to make the list, it is the **first site of the ancient Indus Valley Civilisation (IVC)** in India to get the tag.

Hence, option C is correct.

Q16. Consider the following with reference to heritage and culture of India:

1. Ramman
2. Daskathia
3. Garba
4. Theyyam

How many of the above given Cultural items are in the UNESCO's list of the Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity?

- A. Only one
- B. Only two
- C. Only three
- D. All four

Answer: B

Explanation:

UNESCO's list of the Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity consists of 15 cultural items (as of Jan 2024).

- **Ramman** is a **folk dance of Uttarakhand** included in UNESCO's list 2009.
- **Garba**, a form of dance originating from the state of **Gujarat**, India, derives its name from the Sanskrit term "**Garbha**." This traditional dance is often performed around a centrally lit lamp or an image of the Hindu goddess Shakti. This is the 15th and latest cultural item added in the list in 2023.
- **Theyyam** is a popular ritual **form of dance worship** in **Kerala** and certain parts of **Karnataka**. The people consider Theyyam itself as a channel to a god and they thus seek blessings from Theyyam. It is performed by individuals from castes and tribes such as Pulayar, Vannan, Malayan, Velan, and Kalanaadi.
- **Daskathia** is a **form of ballad singing** prevalent in **Odisha**. Its name derived from a unique musical instrument called "Kathi" or "Ram Tali", wooden clappers used during the presentation. The performance is a form of worship and offering on behalf of the "Das", the devotee.
- Both **Theyyam** and **Daskathia** are **not part of UNESCO's list of the Intangible Cultural Heritage**.
- **List of Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity**

ICH Elements	Year of inscription
1. Tradition of Vedic chanting	2008
2. Ramlila, the traditional performance of the Ramayana	2008
3. Kutiyattam, Sanskrit theatre	2008
4. Ramman, religious festival and ritual theatre of the Garhwal Himalayas, India	2009
5. Mudi yettu, ritual theatre and dance drama of Kerala	2010
6. Kalbelia folk songs and dances of Rajasthan	2010
7. Chhau dance	2010
8. Buddhist chanting of Ladakh: recitation of sacred Buddhist texts in the trans-Himalayan Ladakh region, Jammu and Kashmir, India	2012
9. Sankirtana, ritual singing, drumming and dancing of Manipur	2013
10. Traditional brass and copper craft of utensil making among the Thatheras of Jandiala Guru,	

Punjab, India	
11. Yoga	2016
12. Nawrouz, Novruz, Nowrouz, Nowrouz, Nawrouz, Nauryz, Nooruz, Nowruz, Navruz, Nevruz, Nowruz, Navruz	2016
13. Kumbh Mela	2017
14. Durga Puja in Kolkata	2021
15. Garba of Gujarat	2023

Hence, option B is correct.

Q17. Consider the following statement regarding Adi Shankaracharya:

1. He propounded the doctrine of Advaita.
2. He established four Mathas at Shingeri, Puri, Dwarka and Badrinath.
3. He provided support to his contemporary Buddhist philosophers.

How many of the above statements is/are correct?

- A. Only one
- B. Only two
- C. All three
- D. None

Answer: B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Propounded the Doctrine of Advaita (Monism) and wrote many commentaries on the Vedic canon (Upanishads, Brahma Sutras and Bhagavad Gita) in Sanskrit.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** He is said to have established **four Mathas** (Hindu Monasteries) at **Shingeri, Puri, Dwarka and Badrinath**– for propagation of Sanathana Dharma in four corners of India.
- **Statement 3 is not correct:** He was responsible to revive Hindu philosophy at a time when Buddhism was gaining momentum in India. Thus, he was opposed to Buddhist philosophers.

Hence, option B is correct.

Q18. With reference to the reference historical sites associated with Buddhism, consider the following statements:

1. Rajgriha and Sankasya are important sites considered being part of 'Ashtasthanas' in Buddhism.
2. Bodh Gaya is situated on the banks of the Niranjana River.
3. Kusinagar is associated with 'Dharma-chakra-pravartana' event in Buddhism.

4. Mahabodhi Temple is located in Bodh Gaya and it holds UNESCO World Heritage status.

How many of the statements given above is/are correct?

- A. Only one
- B. Only two
- C. Only three
- D. All four

Answer: C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** In Buddhism, the term '**Ashtashtanas**' signifies the **Eight Great Places** connected to pivotal events in the life of Lord Buddha. These include (i) Lumbini (ii) Bodh Gaya (iii) Sarnath, and (iv) Kusinagar and to these foundational four sites, an additional four are included: (v) Sravasti, (vi) **Rajgriha**, (vii) Vaishali, and (viii) **Sankasya**.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Gaya and **Bodh Gaya** are situated along River Phalgu. In ancient texts it was known as **Niranjana River**.
- **Statement 3 is not correct:** Buddha gave his **first sermon at Sarnath** and the event is known as '**Dharma-chakra-pravartana**'. Buddha died at **Kusinagar** and the event is known as **Mahaparinirvana**.
- **Statement 4 is correct:** Mahabodhi Temple holds **UNESCO World Heritage status** and is located in **Bodh Gaya** (during Buddha's time it was known as Uruwela), Bihar, India.

Hence, option C is correct.

Q19. Which of the following areas/fields are **NOT** covered by the UNESCO Creative Cities Network?

- 1. Media arts
- 2. Literature
- 3. Space Exploration
- 4. Gastronomy
- 5. Crafts and Folk art

Choose the correct answer from the options given below:

- A. Only two
- B. Only three
- C. Only four
- D. All five

Answer: C

Explanation:

- **UNESCO Creative Cities Network** was created in 2004. It aims to promote cooperation among cities which recognize creativity as a strategic factor in their urban development.

- The network covers **seven creative fields: crafts and folk arts, media arts, film, design, gastronomy, literature and music**. However, it does not cover **Space exploration**.
- It is aligned with **Sustainable Development Goal 11**, which targets Sustainable Cities and Communities
- **Gwalior** in Madhya Pradesh and **Kozhikode** in Kerala have recently been added in the list of UNESCO's Creative Cities Network in the '**City of Music**' and '**City of Literature**' categories, respectively.

Cities	Category	Year added
1. Jaipur	Crafts and Folk arts	2015
2. Varanasi	Music	2015
3. Chennai	Music	2017
4. Mumbai	Film	2019
5. Hyderabad	Gastronomy	2019
6. Srinagar	Crafts and Folk arts	2021
7. Gwalior	Music	2023
8. Kozhikode	Literature	2023

Hence, option C is correct.

Q20. Consider the following pairs:

<i>Jain sites</i>	<i>States</i>
1. Shatrunjay hill	Jharkhand
2. Sammed Sikhar	Gujarat
3. Udayagiri-Khandagiri	Madhya Pradesh
4. Sittanavasal	Tamil Nadu

How many of the above pairs is/are correctly matched?

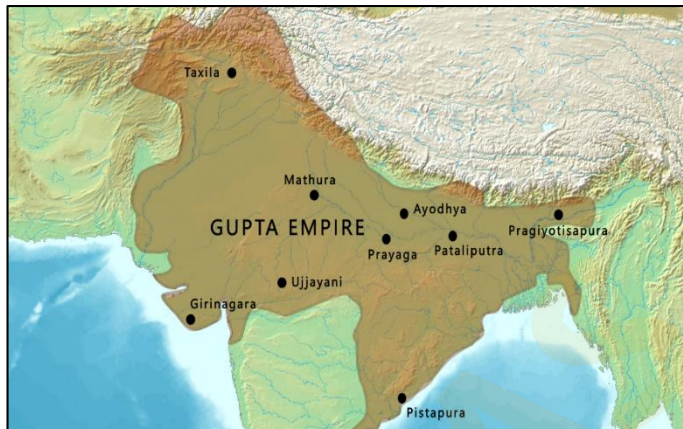
- A. Only one
- B. Only two
- C. Only three
- D. All four

Answer: A

Explanation:

- **Pair 1 is not correct:** Shatrunjay hills are located on the bank of Shetrunji river in Bhavnagar in Gujarat.
- **Pair 2 is not correct:** Sammed Sikhar is one of the most important pilgrimage centres for Jains. These are also called as Parasnath hills, named after Parasnath (23rd Tirthankara). Twenty Jain Tirthankaras attained salvation on this hill.

- **Pair 3 is not correct:** Udayagiri-Khandagiri hills are renowned for their rock cut caves, located in **Odisha**. These were carved in the era of King Kharvela who built these caves were Jain monks.
- **Pair 4 is correct:** Sittanavasal Cave is a 2nd-century Tamil Sramaṇa complex of caves in Sittanavasal village in Pudukottai district of Tamil Nadu. This is the only place in Tamil Nadu where one can see Pandya era paintings. It is famous for fresco paintings in the rock-cut Jaina cave temple.



Hence, option A is correct.

Q21. Arrange the following ancient cities from west to east:

1. Mathura
2. Pragyotisapura
3. Ayodhya
4. Pataliputra

Which option given below is the correct arrangement?

- A. 1-3-2-4
- B. 3-2-1-4
- C. 1-3-4-2
- D. 3-1-4-2

Answer: C

Explanation:

- **Mathura** is located in northern India on the banks of the **Yamuna River**. It is considered sacred city in Hinduism and is associated with the birth of Lord Krishna. It holds historical significance as a center for trade and culture in ancient times.
- **Ayodhya** is an ancient city situated on the banks of the **Sarayu River**. It is revered in Hinduism as the birthplace of Lord Rama and has been a center for religious and cultural activities throughout history.
- **Pataliputra, also known as present-day Patna**, was a prominent city in ancient India and served as the capital of several dynasties, including the Maurya and Gupta empires. It played a crucial role in political, economic, and cultural developments during that era.
- **Pragyotisapura, now identified with modern-day Guwahati**, was an ancient city in the region of Assam. It was an important urban center during different periods of Indian

history, contributing to the cultural and historical heritage of the northeastern part of the country.

Hence, Option C is correct.

Q22. With reference Inscription during Gupta Age, consider the following statements:

1. Allahabad Pillar Inscription refers to the achievements of Chandragupta I.
2. Mehrauli Iron Pillar Inscription is an important source for Gupta period.
3. Bhitari Pillar Inscription gives the chronology of Guptas and Chandragupta II conflict with Hunas.

How many of the above statements is/are correct?

- A. Only one
- B. Only two
- C. All three
- D. None

Answer: A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is not correct:** The **Allahabad Pillar Inscription** primarily highlights the **military achievements of Samudragupta, not Chandragupta I**. It offers valuable insights into the expansive reign of Samudragupta, showcasing his conquests and administrative capabilities.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The **Mehrauli Iron Pillar Inscription** is associated with the Gupta period and remains renowned for its **metallurgical uniqueness**. It lauds Gupta ruler **Chandragupta II**, providing insights into **politics, arts, and sciences**.
- **Statement 3 is not correct:** The Bhitari Pillar Inscription is such an important historical record that tells us about the Guptas, especially **Skandagupta**. It plays a great role in understanding the lineage of the Guptas.

Hence, Option A is correct.

Q23. Consider the following pairs:

Artform	Region
1. Patua Art	Bengal
2. Pattachitra Painting	Odisha
3. Paitkar Painting	Punjab

Which of the pairs given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 3 only
- C. 1, 2 and 3
- D. None

Answer: A

Explanation:

- **Pair 1 is correct: Patua Art, indigenous to Bengal**, is a traditional narrative **scroll-painting** form. Patuas, or traditional scroll painters, use vivid colors to depict stories, folklore, and societal issues. This engaging art form often serves as a visual medium for storytelling during local festivals and events.
- **Pair 2 is correct: Pattachitra Painting, a traditional art of Odisha**, is characterized by intricate details and vibrant colors. These paintings often depict mythological themes and stories, executed on cloth or canvas.
- **Pair 3 is not correct: Paitkar Painting**, practiced by tribal communities in **Jharkhand**, is a unique art form known for its **use of natural colors**. Tribal artisans create paintings featuring flora, fauna, and tribal life, showcasing the rich cultural heritage of the region.

Hence, Option A is correct.

Q24. Consider the following statements regarding Bhakti Saints:

1. Both Kabir and Guru Nanak belonged to Saguna school.
2. Chaitanya Mahaprabhu popularized kirtan in Bengal region.
3. Writings of Namdev are included in Guru Granth Sahib.
4. Shankardeva propagated the philosophy of Eksarana Dharma.

How many of the statements given above is/are **NOT** correct?

- A. Only one
- B. Only two
- C. Only three
- D. All four

Answer: A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is not correct:** **Kabir** believed in Vaishnavism and had a strong bent towards Advaita philosophy, signifying presence of God inside every person and everything. **Guru Nanakdev** believed in 'God as formless' and said to have been inspired by Kabir. Thus, both of them were Nirguna saints (not saguna).
- **Statement 2 is correct:** **Chaitanya Mahaprabhu** popularized **kirtans (religious songs)** as a form of worship to Krishna in Bengal region.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** **Namdev** was bhakti saint from **Maharashtra**. He worshipped **Lord Vithoba**. He was considered sarguna in compositions in Maharashtra. When he came to north, he became **Nirguna** and his **Nirguna compositions** are included in **Guru Granth Sahib**.

- **Statement 4 is correct:** Shankardeva was a Vaishnav saint and socio-religious reformer in Assam. He propagated the philosophy of “Eksarana Dharma” (one god) in the form of Lord Krishna.
- **Additional Relevant Information:**
 - **Guru Granth Sahib** is written in **Gurmukhi script** and encompasses various languages, including Punjabi, Lahnda, regional Prakrits, Apabhramsa, Sanskrit, Hindi languages (Braj Bhasha, Bangru, Awadhi, Old Hindi), Bhojpuri, Sindhi, Marathi, Marwari, Bengali, Persian, and Arabic.
 - It also incorporates the teachings of Hindu Bhakti movement saints, such as **Ramananda, Kabir, Namdev, Sheikh Farid** (Muslim sufi saint).

Hence, option A is correct.

Q25. Consider the following statements:

1. According to Natya Shastra, Lasya in Indian classical dance represents the masculine features of dance with emphasis on rhythm and movement.
2. Tandava is associated with grace, bhava, rasa, and abhinaya, symbolizing the feminine aspects of dance as an art form.

Which of the statements given above is/are **not** correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is not correct:** According to Natya Shastra, Lasya, in Indian classical dance, embodies the feminine aspects, emphasizing grace, bhava (expression), rasa (aesthetic sentiment), and abhinaya (artistic expression). It symbolizes the softer, more emotive elements of the dance, often associated with the portrayal of love, beauty, and tenderness.
- **Statement 2 is not correct:** Tandava, on the other hand, is associated with the masculine features of dance, placing a greater emphasis on rhythm and movement. It embodies the dynamic and forceful aspects of the art form, portraying power and energy.

Hence, Option C is correct.

Q26. Consider the following statements with regards to folk songs:

1. Ovi songs are primarily performed by men during festive occasions.
2. Pai Songs, originating from Madhya Pradesh, are sung during festivals.

3. Lavani is a well-known folk-dance form of Maharashtra.

How many of the statements given above are correct?

- A. Only one
- B. Only two
- C. All three
- D. None

Answer: B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is not correct:** Ovi songs are primarily sung by **women in Maharashtra and Goa** during leisure time and household work. They usually consist of four-line poetry and cover themes like marriages, pregnancy, and lullabies.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** **Pai Songs from Madhya Pradesh** are sung during festivals, especially those falling in the rainy season. These songs typically seek blessings for a good monsoon and harvest, catering to the agricultural communities.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** **Lavani is a famous folk dance of Maharashtra**, is a combination of traditional dance and song. Accompanied by the beats of the Dholki, it features powerful rhythms suitable for lively dancing.

Hence, Option B is correct.

Q27. With reference to Sangam Society, consider the following statements:

- 1. Sangam society was matriarchal in nature.
- 2. Women were allowed to choose their partners.
- 3. Kadasiyar was the ruling class and Arasar was the lower-class people.
- 4. There was no prevalence of sati in this period.

How many of the above statements is/are correct?

- A. Only one
- B. Only two
- C. Only three
- D. All four

Answer: A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is not correct:** The Sangam society was **not matriarchal but rather patriarchal**, marked by a system where rulers, administrative staff, and various offices were directly controlled by male leaders. This reflected a society organized along paternalistic lines.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Women were allowed to choose their partners. **Karpū** or Chaste life was considered the **highest virtue of women**. Love marriage was accepted in Sangam society.

- **Statement 3 is not correct:** Kadasiyar was the **lower-class people** and Arasar was the **ruling class**. Vellalar were agriculturists, Vanigar were involved in trade and commerce.
- **Statement 4 is not correct:** Widows' life was miserable. The **practice of sati was also prevalent** in the higher strata of society.

Hence, Option A is correct.

Q28. 'Mahanavmi Dibba', 'Lotus Mahal', and 'Kalyana Mandapams' were notable architectural contributions of which of the following dynasty or empire?

- A. Chalukya
- B. Chandela
- C. Rashtrakuta
- D. Vijayanagara

Answer: D

Explanation:

- **Mahanavmi Dibba:** It was the name of a massive platform with a base covered with relief carvings.
- **Lotus Mahal:** It is a **two storied palace** in the shape of lotus. It is called as Kamal Mahal or Chitragani Mahal. It is built in rubble masonry and finely plastered. The structure was used as residue place for royal family of the Vijayanagara Empire.
- **Kalyana Mandapams:** The chief characteristics of the Vijayanagar architecture were the **Construction of tall Raya Gopurams** (gateways) and the **Kalyana mandapam** with carved pillars in the temple premises.

Hence, option D is correct.

Q29. Consider the following statements with reference to the Konark Sun Temple:

1. The temple is known as Black Pagoda due to its dark colour.
2. It was built by King Narasimhadeva I.
3. It is a UNESCO world heritage site.
4. It is the only west facing temple in India.

How many of the above statements is/are correct?

- A. Only one
- B. Only two
- C. Only three
- D. All four

Answer: C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Konark Sun Temple is also known as Black Pagoda. The temple is built from **Khondalite** rocks, which gives it a dark appearance.

- **Statement 2 is correct:** It was built by **King Narasimhadeva I** of the **eastern Ganga dynasty** in **1244**.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** It was given the status of a World Heritage Site in 1984 by UNESCO. It is located on the coastline of Odisha in Puri district.
- **Statement 4 is not correct:** It is a classic example of the **Odisha style of Architecture** or **Kalinga Architecture**. The temple complex has the appearance of a 100-foot-high solar chariot, with 24 wheels and pulled by six horses, all carved from stone. It is **oriented towards the east** so that the first rays of the sunrise strike the main entrance.
- An important **west facing temple** is Mahakaleshwar temple.

Hence, option C is correct.

Q30. Consider the following pairs:

<i>Indus Valley Cities</i>	<i>Located on River</i>
1. Mohenjodaro	Indus
2. Harappa	Ravi
3. Kalibangan	Beas
4. Daimabad	Pravara

How many of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

- A. Only one
- B. Only two
- C. Only three
- D. All four

Answer: C

Explanation:

- **Pair 1 is correct:** The city of **Mohenjodaro** was located on the banks of the river **Indus**. It was discovered by RD Banerjee.
- **Pair 2 is correct:** The city of **Harappa** was located on the river **Ravi**. It was the first city to be discovered and hence the Indus Valley Civilization is also known as the Harappan Civilization. It was discovered by Dayaram Sahni.
- **Pair 3 is not correct:** The city of **Kalibangan** was located on the banks of the **Ghaggar-Hakra River** in the present-day state of Rajasthan whereas the river Beas flows through the states of Himachal Pradesh and Punjab.
- **Pair 4 is correct:** **Daimabad** is located on the banks of **Pravara** River.

Hence, option C is correct.

Q31. Consider the following statements regarding National Monuments Authority:

1. It is a statutory body under Ministry of Tourism.
2. It has been set up as per provisions of Ancient Monuments and Archaeological Sites and Remains (Amendment and Validation) Act, 2010.
3. It makes recommendations to central government for grading and classifying protected monuments and protected areas.

Which of the above statements are correct?

- A. 1 and 3 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 3 only
- D. 1 and 2 only

Answer: B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is not correct:** National Monuments Authority (NMA) is a statutory body under Ministry of Culture, Government of India.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** It has been setup as per provisions of The Ancient Monuments and Archaeological Sites and Remains AMASR (Amendment and Validation) Act, 2010. Several functions have been assigned to the NMA for the protection and preservation of monuments and sites through management of the prohibited and regulated area around the centrally protected monuments. One amongst these responsibilities of NMA is also to consider grant of permissions to applicants for construction related activity in the prohibited and regulated area.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** It makes recommendations to central government for grading and classifying protected monuments and protected areas. To categorize all protected monuments and protected areas declared as of National importance as per AMASR act 1958, is also the function of NMA.

Hence, option B is correct.

Q32. Consider the following statements regarding Jainism:

1. 'Jaina' comes from the term 'Jina' which meaning conqueror.
2. Brahmacharya, one of the 5 great Vows of Jainism, was added by Rishabh Nath.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Jainism came to prominence in the 6th century B.C., when Lord Mahavira propagated the religion. The word **Jaina** comes from the term **Jina**, meaning **conqueror**. It is also known as **Jitendriya** which means one who has conquered his senses.
- **Statement 2 is not correct:** The first Tirthankara was **Rishabhdeva** and the last (24th) was Lord Mahavira. The five great vows are: **Ahimsa, Satya, Asteya, Aparigraha, Brahmacharya**.
- **Brahmacharya** (Celibacy/Chastity) was added by **Lord Mahavira**.

Hence, option A is correct.

Q33. Consider the following statements with reference to Muhammad bin Tughlaq:

1. Ibn Batuta visited his court and recorded his observations in his book Qitab-ul-Rihla.
2. He established agriculture department and gave loans for cultivation.
3. He built the towns like Hissar and Jaunpur.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1, 2 and 3
- D. 1 and 3 only

Answer: A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Muhammad bin Tughlaq came to throne in 1325. Ibn Batuta was a Moroccan traveler who visited his court. He recorded his observation in his book **Qitab-ul-Rihla**. Later he was sent to China as ambassador of Tughlaq.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** He established **agriculture department**, known as **Diwan-i-kohi** to focus on converting uncultivated land into an agricultural field. He gave '**Takkavi loans**' (loans for cultivation) to the farmers to buy seed and to extend cultivation.
- **Statement 3 is not correct:** Muhammad bin Tughlaq built **Adilabad Fort** and added Jahanpanah city to Delhi. **Firoz Shah Tughlaq** constructed towns like **Firozabad** (now known as Firozshah Kotla), **Hissar, Jaunpur**, and **Fatehabad**.

Hence, option A is correct.

Q34. With reference to Buddhism Literature, consider the following statements:

1. Suttapitaka consists of monastic codes and was composed by Upali.
2. Vinayapitaka consists of Buddha's teachings, composed by Anand.
3. Lalitvistara was a Hinayana text consisting of flowery narrative of Buddha's life.

How many of the above statements is/are correct?

- A. Only one
- B. Only two

- C. All three
- D. None

Answer: D

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is not correct:** Suttapitaka are Buddhist teachings and sayings compiled by Ananda. It consists of five Nikayas i.e Dighanikaya, Anguttara nikaya, Majjhima Nikaya Khudakka nikaya, Samyuktta nikaya.
- **Statement 2 is not correct:** Vinayapitaka comprises of monastic code containing the rules to be followed by monks in the monasteries, compiled by Upali.
- **Statement 3 is not correct:** Lalitvistara was a Mahayana text consisting of flowery narrative of Buddha's life. It was utilized by Sir Edwin Arnold for his 'The light of Asia'.

Hence, option D is correct.

Q35. With reference to the Indian classical music, consider the following statements:

1. The nature of dhrupad is devotional while that of khayal is romantic.
2. Dhrupad emphasizes lyrics while khayal focuses on raag.
3. Dhrupad employs Tabla and Harmonium while Khayal does not.
4. Khayal is older than the dhrupad vocal form.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- A. Only one
- B. Only two
- C. Only three
- D. All four

Answer: B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The nature of Dhrupad music is devotional. It seeks to induce feelings of peace and spirituality in the listener. Dhrupad was initially sung only in the temples, the singer facing the Lord. Khayal is a Persian term which means imagination. The romantic element dominates the Khayal form.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Dhrupad puts a strong emphasis on text and lyrics while Khayal keeps the actual content of the lyrics as secondary to the way they are used to express the nuances of the raag. Lyrical syllables that have no dictionary meaning are often used in khayal. Khayal demands strict adherence to the musical grammar of the chosen raag.
- **Statement 3 is not correct:** Traditionally, the accompanying instruments to Dhrupad Singing are only Taanpura and Pakhawaj.
 - Khayal employs Tabla and Harmonium as accompaniment along with the Tanpura. Now we can witness that the Violin and Sarangi too have been used as an accompaniment.

- **Statement 4 is not correct:** Dhrupad music is the older version of vocal music. It is generally traced back to the legendary Tansen in Akbar's Mughal court in the 16th century.
 - Khayal was developed sometime later and replaced dhrupad in 18th century as the more popular vocal form.

Hence, option B is correct.

Q36. Consider the following statements with reference to Chishti Order/Silsilah:

1. It was founded by Qutubuddin Bakhtiyar Kaki.
2. Its doctrine emphasized the unity of being with God.
3. Saints belonging to this silsilah used to accept maintenance grants from the Sultans.

How many of the above statements is/are correct?

- A. Only one
- B. Only two
- C. All three
- D. None

Answer: A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is not correct:** Chishti Order was founded in India by Khwaja Moinuddin Chishti. Qutubuddin Bakhtiyar Kaki was the direct disciple of Khwaja Moinuddin Chisti.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** It emphasised the doctrine of the unity of being with God (wahdat al-wujūd) and members of the order were also pacifists.
- **Statement 3 is not correct:** Saints belonging to this silsilah abstained from having connection with the secular state. They rejected all material goods as distractions from the contemplation of God. The members of the Suhrawardi order, unlike the Chishtis, accepted maintenance grants from the Sultans.

Hence, Option A is correct.

Q37. With reference to Boddhisatvas, consider the following statements:

1. The concept of Boddhisatvas was central to the Hinayana sect of Buddhism.
2. Boddhisatva was thought not only as a spirit of compassion but also of suffering.
3. Bodhisattvas can only incarnate as human beings.

How many of the above statements is/are correct?

- A. Only one
- B. Only two
- C. All three
- D. None

Answer: A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is not correct:** The one who had taken the vow of brotherhood was called Boddhisatva. The **concept of Boddhisatvas** was central and ideal to **Mahayana Buddhist tradition**.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Boddhisatva was thought not only as a spirit of compassion but also of suffering. Living being (sattva) who aspires enlightenment (Bodhi) and carries out altruistic practices. Boddhisatva would bide his time until even the smallest insect had reached the highest goal.
- **Statement 3 is not correct:** **Jataka stories** show that **Boddhisatvas** can be incarnated as **men or even as animals**. Even, he need not to be a monk.

Hence, option A is correct.

Q38. The subjects 'Sautrantrikas', 'Sammitiyas', 'Lokottaravadin' belongs to which of the following religion?

- A. Jainism
- B. Buddhism
- C. Vaishnavism
- D. Shaivism

Answer: B

Explanation:

- **Sautrantrikas** and **Sammitiyas** were the subjects of **Hinayana Buddhism** whereas **Lokottaravadin** is an offshoot of **Mahasanghikas** (related to **Mahayana Buddhism**).
- The name Lokottaravada means those who follow the supramundane or transcendent, teachings. This school wrote Biography of Buddha in Sanskrit.

Hence, option B is correct.

Q39. With reference to the cultural history of India, the terms 'Nastaliq' and 'Shikaste' refers to

- A. Hall of private audience
- B. Tall gateway
- C. Type of floor plan consisting of central hall surrounded by eight rooms
- D. Persian writing style

Answer: D

Explanation:

- **Nastaliq** was a **persian cursive writing style**, with **long horizontal strokes** and easy to read.
- **Shikaste** was also a **persian writing style**. It was **dense** and **difficult to read**.
- **Hall of private audience** was known as **Diwan-e-Khas**.
- **Tall gateway** was known as **Pishtaq**.

- **Hasht Bihisht** was a **type of floor plan** consisting of central hall surrounded by eight rooms. It means 'eight heavens' in Persian.

Hence, option D is correct.

Q40. With reference to coins in ancient India, consider the following statements:

1. The Mauryan were the first to introduce punch-marked coins in India.
2. Coins of ancient India were completely secular in all senses.
3. The Kushanas were the first dynasty to issues large number of gold coins.

How many of the following statements is/are correct?

- A. Only one
- B. Only two
- C. All three
- D. None

Answer: A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is not correct:** Punch-marked coins have been minted around 6th century BCE by the **Mahajanapadas** of Indo Gangetic valley. These have been recovered from excavations at a number of sites throughout the sub-continent. During the Mauryan period, Punch marked coins continued to be issued in large quantities.
- **Statement 2 is not correct:** Coins of ancient India showed **tilt towards religious matters**. **Kushan coins** had images related to the **Buddhist era**. **Gupta coins** had images of **Hindu god and goddess**.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** The **Kushanas issued a significant number of gold coins**. The Kushans are known for their gold coins that featured various rulers, deities, and symbols. These coins were an important aspect of the Kushan economy and played a role in facilitating trade and commerce within their empire.

Hence, option A is correct.

Q41. With reference to trade and commerce during the Mauryan period, consider the following statements:

1. Land was the main route of trade and ports were non-existent.
2. The Greeks were the major importers of the Indian goods.
3. The state had monopoly in mining and metallurgy.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- A. 2 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is not correct:** The expansion of commerce and trade enabled the Mauryans to augment their resources and revenue. Although **trade through land route was the main source of exports and imports, ports were also used to trade beyond the borders.** The port of **Tamralipti** acted as an exit point to the south and the south-east.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Establishment of friendly relations with the Greeks under the Mauryan kings, like **Bindusara** and **Ashoka**, improved trade relations. External trade was also carried on with Syria, Egypt etc. in the west. The chief articles of export were spices, pearls, diamonds, sandalwoods, ivory, cotton cloth, silk yarn, muslin, etc. The principal imports were linen, silver, gold, dry fruits, etc
- **Statement 3 is correct:** An important aspect of Mauryan economy was the **state monopoly of mining and metallurgy.** It was a source of great income.

Hence, option B is correct.

Q42. Consider the following Medieval texts:

1. Ain-e Akbari
2. Qanun-i-Humayuni
3. Baburnama
4. Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri
5. Humayun Nama

Which of the above are **NOT** an autobiography?

- A. Only two
- B. Only three
- C. Only four
- D. All five

Answer: B

Explanation:

- **Ain-e Akbari, Qanun-i-Humayuni and Humayun Nama are not autobiographies.**
 - The **Ain-i-Akbari**, or the "Administration of Akbar," is a 16th-century detailed document recording the **administration of the Mughal Empire** under Emperor Akbar, written by **Abul Fazl**, in the Persian language.
 - **Qanun –i-Humayuni** was composed in 1534 CE by **Khvandamir**, one of the officials under Humayun's patronage. It is about the Work on the Rules and Ordinances Established by the Emperor Humayun.
 - **Humayun Nama** is a biography of Humayun written by **Gulbadan Begum (sister of Humayun).**

- **Baburnama and Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri (Jahangir-nama) are autobiographies.**
 - **Baburnama** was written by **Babur**. It was translated by **Abdul Rahim Khan-e-Khana** in **Persian language** during reign of **Akbar**.
 - **Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri** talks about his great interest in arts and his efforts to achieve scientific correctness in rendering flora and fauna that interested the emperor the most. It was written in the Persian language.

Only two Mughal emperors wrote their autobiographies i.e. **Babur and Jahangir**.

Hence, option B is correct.

Q43. With reference to the imperial Cholas, which one of the following is the correct sequence in descending order in terms of size?

- A. Mandalam, Valanadu, Korram, Ur
- B. Valanadu, Mandalam, Korram, Ur
- C. Mandalam, Korram, Valanadu, Ur
- D. Valanadu, Korram, Mandalam, Ur

Answer: A

Explanation:

- The Chola State was marked for its uniqueness and innovativeness during the imperial period (850- 1200). **King Vijayalaya** is the **founder** of the Imperial Cholas in the ninth century.
- Every **village (Ur)** was a self-governing unit. A **number of such villages** constituted a **Korram, Nadu** or **Kottam** in different parts of the country.
- A **number of Kurrams** constituted a **Valanadu**. **Several Valanadus made up one Mandalam**, a province and **Ur was the primary village** assembly in the Chola village administration.
- Mandalam, Valanadu and Kurram were the administrative divisions in descending order in terms of size.

Hence, option A is correct.

Q44. With reference to the period of Gupta dynasty in ancient India, the towns Kalyan, Kadura and Chaul were well known as

- A. Regional trade centers
- B. Important Jainism sites
- C. Places of rock cut cave architecture
- D. Ports handling foreign trade.

Answer: D

Explanation:

- During Gupta period, ports on **East Coast Ports** were **Tamralipti, Ghamantasala, Kadura** which handled the **North Indian trade with South-East Asia**. Those of the **west coast** including **Bharoach, Chaul, Kalyan** and **Cambay** traded with the **Mediterranean and West Asia**.

Hence, option D is correct.

Q45. With reference to Guru Ravidas, consider the following statements:

1. He was opposed to the Bhakti movement.
2. He was a disciple of Sant Kabir and followed Nirguna form of bhakti.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is not correct:** **Guru Ravidas** was a **14th-century saint and reformer** of the **Bhakti movement** in North India. He was **not opposed** of it.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** He was a **disciple of Sant Kabir**. He **abandoned Saguna** (with attributes, image) forms of supreme beings, and focused on the **Nirguna (without attributes, abstract)** form of supreme beings.

Hence, option B is correct.

Q46. With reference to the Indian Schools of Philosophy, which one of the following schools believes in the physicality of the Universe and argue that everything in the Universe was created by fire, air, water, earth and sky?

- A. Samkhya School
- B. Nyaya School
- C. Vaisheshika School
- D. Vedanta School

Answer: C

Explanation:

- **Vaisheshika system** is considered the realistic and objective philosophy of the Universe.
- According to this philosophy, reality has many bases or categories: substance, attribute, action, genus, distinct quality and inherence.
- Vaisheshika thinkers believe that **all objects of the Universe are composed of five elements—earth, water, air, fire and sky**. They believe that **God is the guiding principle**. The living beings were rewarded or punished according to the karma law, based on merit and

demerit actions. Creation and destruction of the Universe was a cyclic process and took place in agreement with the wishes of God.

- **Kanada** wrote the basic text of **Vaisheshika philosophy**.
- It explained the **phenomena of the Universe through the atomic theory**, the **combination of atoms and molecules into matter** and **explained the mechanical process of the formation of the Universe**.

Hence, option C is correct.

Q47. Consider the following statements with reference to the Qutub Minar:

1. Qutub-ud-din Aibak started the construction of Qutub Minar after the name of famous Sufi saint Khwaja Qutubuddin Bakhtiyar Kaki.
2. It is largely built of marble with some use of red and buff sandstone.
3. Muhammad bin Tughlaq constructed the fifth storey.

How many of the following statements is/are correct?

- A. Only one
- B. Only two
- C. All three
- D. None

Answer: A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Qutub-ud-din Aibak started the **construction of Qutub Minar** in 1193 after the name of famous Sufi saint **Khwaja Qutubuddin Bakhtiyar Kaki**.
- **Statement 2 is not correct:** The **first three storeys** are made of **red sandstone**; the **fourth and fifth storeys** are of **marble and sandstone**. Therefore, Qutub Minar is largely built with **red and buff sandstone** with **some use of marble in upper storeys**.
- **Statement 3 is not correct:** **Successor of Iltutmush** added **three more storeys**, and in 1368, **Firoz Shah Tughlak** constructed the **fifth storey**.

Hence, option A is correct.

Q48. Which of the following changes in the 'Mesolithic phase' prepared the way for the formation of civilisation in later phases?

1. Climate became warm and dry.
2. During Mesolithic phase people started fishing and food gathering.
3. Domestication of animals started during this phase.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- A. 3 only
- B. 1 and 2 only

- C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Upper Palaeolithic Age came to an end with the end of the Ice Age around 9000 BC and Mesolithic phase started. **The climate became warm and dry which brought about changes in flora and fauna and made it easier for humans to travel.**
- **Statement 2 is not correct:** Fishing and food gathering were present already in the Upper Palaeolithic phase.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Domestication of animals started during Mesolithic phase. Domestication of animals is a crucial step towards agriculture and settled life, both of which are associated with the development of civilization.

Hence, option C is correct.

Q49. Consider the following statements:

1. Jizya is a tax levied and collected per head by Islamic states on non-Muslim subjects living on their land.
2. In India, Iltutmish imposed jizya on non-muslims for the first time.
3. Jizya was abolished by Firuz Shah Tughlaq in the 14th century.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Jizya is a tax levied and collected per head by Islamic states on non-Muslim subjects living in their land. This tax applied especially to followers of Judaism, Christianity, and Zoroastrianism, who were tolerated in the practice of their religion because they were “peoples of the book.”
- **Statement 2 is not correct:** After conquest of Sindh, Mohammad Bin Kasim imposed Jaziya for the first time. However, it was Qutb-ud-din Aibak who imposed jizya on non-Muslims for the first time in Delhi sultanate.
- **Statement 3 is not correct:** Firuz Shah Tughlaq (1351–1388) favored orthodox Islamic practices and imposed jizya, a head tax on non-muslims, which even the Brahmins were compelled to pay.

Hence, option C is correct.

Q50. Consider the following statements regarding Mauryan art and architecture:

1. Sandstone was the principle building material used in construction of palaces.
2. Ashokan pillar edicts were in Prakrit and Pali language only.
3. Mauryan period was renowned for its monumental sculptures.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- A. 2 only
- B. 1 and 3 only
- C. 3 only
- D. 1 only

Answer: C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is not correct:** Wood was the **principal building material** used in construction of palaces during the Mauryan Empire. Greek historian, **Megasthenes**, described the palaces of the Mauryan empire as one of the greatest creations of mankind and Chinese traveler FaHien called Mauryan palaces as God gifted monuments.
- **Statement 2 is not correct:** While most Ashoka pillar edicts were in **Pali** and **Prakrit** language, few were written in **Greek or Aramaic** language also.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Mauryan period was renowned for its monumental sculptures such as yakshas, yakshinis and various animals. The prominent statues of yaksha and yakshini were found in **Patna, Vidisha, and Mathura**, with a standout Yakshi figure from **Didarganj, Patna**.

Hence, option C is correct.

Q51. Consider the following statements:

He commissioned the construction of Adhai din ka Jhopra in Ajmer. Because of his liberal donations (1 lakh Copper coins or Jitals) as charity, Muslim writers call him 'Lakh Baksh'. He patronized the great scholar Hasan Nizami. He died while playing Chaugan.

The above statements refer to which of the following ruler of Delhi Sultanate?

- A. Iltutmish
- B. Ghiyassuddin Balban
- C. Firoz Shah Tughlaq
- D. Qutubuddin Aibak

Answer: D

Explanation:

- **Qutubuddin Aibak** came to power in 1206 and expanded the **Ghurid power** in northern India by conquering and raiding several places in the Chahamana, Gahadavala, Chaulukya, Chandela, and other kingdoms.

- After being recognized as the ruler of India, Aibak focused on consolidating his rule in the territories already under his control, rather than conquering new territories.
- He assumed the title of **Sultan** and made **Lahore** his Capital to secure the northwestern frontier of the kingdom.
- He started **Construction of Qutub Minar** after the name of famous Sufi saint Khwaja Qutubuddin Bakhtiyar Kaki. He commissioned the **construction of Adhai din ka Jhopra in Ajmer**.
- He patronized the great scholar **Hasan Nizami** (Persian poet) and **Fakh-e-Mudabbir** (Persian author).
- Aibak died while playing **Chaugan** (Horse polo) in 1210 AD.

Hence, option D is correct.

Q52. Consider the following statements regarding Jainism:

1. First Jain council was held at Vallabhi under the chairmanship of Sthulabhadra.
2. Jain literature is mainly written in Prakrit language.
3. Jainism did not recognize the existence of God.
4. It condemned the varna system altogether.

How many of the above statements is/are correct?

- A. Only one
- B. Only two
- C. Only three
- D. All four

Answer: A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is not correct:** First Jain council was held at **Pataliputra** under the chairmanship of **Sthulabhadra**. This outcome of this council was compilation of Angas.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Jain literature is mainly written in **Prakrit** language. It is divided into two major categories:
 1. **Agam literature:** Consists of original scriptures compiled by Gandharas. They are divided into 12 angas, 4 mulasutra, 12 upangas etc.
 2. **Non-agam literature:** Consists of commentary and explanation of Agam literature and independent works, compiled by elder monks, nuns, and scholars.
- **Statement 3 is not correct:** Jainism **recognized the existence of God but less important than jina (Mahavira)**. In Jainism, gods have no role to play in attaining salvation. Nor are they creators of universe.
- **Statement 4 is not correct:** It **did not condemn the varna system** but attempted to mitigate the evils of the varna order and the ritualistic vedic religion.

Hence, option A is correct.

Q53. Consider the following statements regarding foreign travellers who visited India:

1. Abdur Razzak visited Vijayanagara empire during the reign of Devarya II.
2. Peter Mundy was an Italian traveller who came in Mughal period.
3. Francois Bernier was a physician to Dara Shikoh.

How many of the above statements is/are correct?

- A. Only one
- B. Only two
- C. All three
- D. None

Answer: C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Abdur Razzaq (1443-1444 AD) was a Persian, Timurid chronicler, visited the **Vijayanagara Kingdom** at the time of **Dev Raya II**. He talks about the wealth and life in the Vijayanagar kingdom. He wrote book “**Matla-us-Sadain wa Majma-ul-Bahrain**”
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Peter Mundy (1630-1634 AD) was an Italian traveller, came in the reign of the **Shahjahan**.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Francois Bernier (1656-1668 AD) was a doctor, political philosopher and historian, stayed for 12 years in the Mughal Empire. He was closely associated with the Mughal court, as a **physician to Prince Dara Shikoh**.

Hence, option C is correct.

Q54. Which of the following are included in the features of the Kakatiyan architecture?

1. Floating bricks
2. Sand box technique
3. Temples made using multiple types of stones

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation:

Salient Features of the Kakatiyan Architecture

- **Floating bricks:** The Kakatiyas had pioneered a **unique brick making technology** by which **high-strength bricks of very low weights** could be manufactured. These bricks are called the floating bricks.

- **Sand box technique:** The foundation of the temple is built using the sand box technique, which is unique to the Kakatiyan temple architecture. They understood the need for utilizing sand as a material for the foundation.
- **Multiple type of stones:** The temple is constructed using **sandstone**. The temple has **decorated beams and pillars of carved granite and dolerite**.
- **Ramappa temple** is a masterpiece of the **Kakatiyan style of temple architecture**.

Hence, option D is correct.

Q55. Consider the following statements:

Statement-I:

According to the law giver of the Gupta age, women were allowed to sell and mortgage her immovable property along with their stridhana.

Statement-II:

The gifts of jewelry, ornaments, garments and other similar presents made to the bride on the occasion of her marriage were considered as her property.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

- A. Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II is the correct explanation for Statement-I.
- B. Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II is not the correct explanation for Statement-I.
- C. Statement-I is correct but Statement-II is incorrect.
- D. Statement-I is incorrect but Statement-II is correct.

Answer: B

Explanation:

- **Statement-I is correct:** According to **Katyayana**, a law-giver of the 6th century, during the Gupta period, women did have certain property rights, including the ability to own and manage their stridhana. This included:
 - **Movable property:** Jewellery, ornaments, garments, and other gifts received during marriage or other occasions.
 - **Immovable property:** Land or dwelling acquired through inheritance, purchase, or self-acquisition.
- **Statement-II is correct:** **Stridhana**, specifically referring to **gifts given to the bride during marriage**, was indeed considered her personal property. **She had full control over it and could use it, sell it, or gift it as she wished.**
- **However, Statement-I is not the correct explanation of Statement-II:** The reason women could sell or mortgage immovable property is not directly because of stridhana. **It's due to broader property rights granted to women under Gupta law, even though those rights were subject to some restrictions.**

Hence, option B is correct.

Q56. With respect to Harsh era, which of the following observations were made by Hiuen Tsang?

1. Harsha prohibited the use of animal food in his kingdom and punished those who killed any living being.
 2. Dowry system was completely abolished in Harsha's empire.
 3. Harsha organized a religious assembly at Kanauj to honour the Chinese pilgrim Hiuen Tsang.
- Select the correct answer from the options given below:

- A. Only one
- B. Only two
- C. All three
- D. None

Answer: B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** In his early life, Harsha was a devout Saiva but later he became an ardent Hinayana Buddhist. **Hiuen Tsang converted him to Mahayana Buddhism. Harsha prohibited the use of animal food in his kingdom and punished those who kill any living being.**
- **Statement 2 is not correct:** Dowry system was prevalent in Harsha's empire.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Harsha organized a religious assembly at Kanauj to honour the **Chinese pilgrim Hiuen Tsang towards the close of his reign.** He invited representatives of all religious sects. It was attended by 20 kings, 1000 scholars from the Nalanda University, 3000 Hinayanists and Mahayanists, 3000 Brahmins and Jains.

Hence, option B is correct.

Q57. Which one of the following describes best the concept of 'Patichcha-samuppada' in Buddhism?

- A. It is used for the death of an enlightened being, such as the Buddha.
- B. It is the explanation of all phenomena such as the causes of suffering, rebirth, old age and death.
- C. It is an explanation of impermanence involving the rejection of any unchanging, permanent, eternal substances or essences.
- D. It signifies extinction of the flame of desire.

Answer: B

Explanation:

- Patichcha-samuppada is called as the **law of dependent origination**, is one of the important aspects of Buddha's teaching. This was both an **explanation of all phenomena as well as an explanation of dukkha**.
- The elements of this law were presented as a wheel consisting of **12 nidanas**, one leading to the next: **Ignorance** (Avijja), **Formations** (Sankhara), **Consciousness** (Vinnana), **Mind And Body** (Nama-Rupa), **The Six Senses** (Salayatana), **Sense Contact** (Phassa), **Feeling** (Vedana), **Craving** (Tanha), **Attachment** (Upadana), **Becoming** (Bhava), **Birth** (Jati), and **Old Age And Death** (Jaramarana).
- **Nirvana** is extinction of the flame of desire.

Hence, **Option B is correct.**

Q58. Consider the following pairs:

Architecture	Attributed to
1. Kailashnath temple	Rashtrakutas
2. Ajanta caves	Hoysalas
3. Elephanta caves	Kalachuris
4. Airavateshwara temple	Pallavas

How many of the above pairs is/are **NOT** correctly matched?

- A. Only one
- B. Only two
- C. Only three
- D. All four

Answer: B

Explanation:

- **Pair 1 is correct:** The **Kailashnath temple** at the **Ellora caves** is one of the largest rocks cut temples in India. The construction of the temple is attributed to the **Rashtrakuta king Krishna I**.
- **Pair 2 is not correct:** **Ajanta caves** are a group of **Buddhist cave monuments**. The temples are believed to be constructed during the period of 400 to 650 AD. The construction of these temples is believed to have been **started by the Satavahanas**. However, **most of the caves have been constructed under the patronage of the Vakatakas**.
- **Pair 3 is correct:** **Elephanta caves** are **rock cut caves**. They are devoted to **Hinduism**. The famous sculpture of Sadashiva is located here. They are believed to be constructed by the Kalachuris.
- **Pair 4 is not correct:** **Airavateshwara temple** is a temple located in Thanjavur district of Tamil Nadu. This temple has been built by **Rajaraja Chola II**.

Hence, **option B is correct.**

Q59. With reference to the judicial system during Guptas, consider the following statements:

1. Civil and criminal laws were clearly demarcated.
2. The king tried cases with the help of brahmana priests.
3. The guilds of artisans were governed by their own laws.

How many of the above statements is/are **NOT** correct?

- A. Only one
- B. Only two
- C. All three
- D. None

Answer: D

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Judicial system was far more developed under the Guptas than in earlier times. Several law-books were compiled during this period, and for the **first time civil and criminal laws were clearly demarcated**. Theft and adultery fell under criminal law, disputes regarding various types of property under civil law. Elaborate laws were laid down about inheritance.
 - As in earlier times, many laws continued to be based on varna differentiation.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** It was the **duty of the King to uphold the law, and try cases with the help of brahmana priests**.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** **Guilds, known as 'Shrenis', functioned as semi-autonomous bodies regulating their respective trades and professions. They had the authority to frame internal rules and settle disputes among their members, often based on customary practices and guild-specific regulations.**

Hence, option D is correct.

Q60. With reference to the Neolithic site of 'Piklihal', consider the following statements:

1. It is located in the present-day state of Andhra Pradesh of India.
2. Both ash mounds and habitation sites have been found at Piklihal.

Which of the above statement is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is not correct:** Piklihal is located in the **Raichur district of Karnataka** (not Andhra Pradesh).

- **Statement 2 is correct:** The Neolithic inhabitants in Piklihal were **cattle-herders**. They **domesticated cattle, sheep, goats, etc and set up camps surrounded by cowpens made with posts and stakes**. In these enclosures, they accumulated dung. Then the entire camping ground was put to fire and cleared for camping in the next session. **Both ash mounds and habitation sites have been found in Piklihal.**

Hence, option B is correct.

Q61. Consider the following statements with reference to arts of the Indus valley civilization:

1. Beads were made of carnelian, amethyst, jasper, crystal, quartz.
2. The art of bronze-casting was practiced on a wide scale by the Harappans.
3. The famous dancing girl made of copper was found in Harappa.
4. Plain pottery is more common than painted ware.

How many of the above statements is/are correct?

- A. Only one
- B. Only two
- C. Only three
- D. All four

Answer: C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Harappan men and women decorated themselves with a large variety of ornaments. The bead industry seems to have been well-developed, as evident by the factories discovered at **Chanhudaro** and **Lothal**. Beads were made of **carnelian, amethyst, jasper, crystal, quartz, steatite, turquoise, lapis lazuli**, etc.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The art of bronze-casting was practiced on a wide scale by the Harappans. Their bronze statues were made using the '**lost wax**' technique.
- **Statement 3 is not correct:** The famous dancing girl made of copper was found in **Mohenjaodaro**. Bangles cover her left arm, a bracelet and an amulet or bangle adorn her right arm, and a cowry shell necklace is seen around her neck
- **Statement 4 is correct:** Plain pottery is generally of red clay, with or without a fine red or grey slip. It includes knobbed ware ornamented with rows of knobs. The black-painted ware has a fine coating of red slip on which geometric and animal designs are executed in glossy black paint. Pottery reflected status in the society. Common people used plain pottery. Thus it was more common than painted ware.

Hence, option C is correct.

Q62. “The theory of Syadvada” is related to which of the following?

- A. Buddhism
- B. Vaishnavism
- C. Jainism
- D. Vedanta

Answer: C

Explanation:

- **Syadvada is related to Jainism.** It is the epistemology of Jaina philosophy. It is the theory of **relativity of knowledge**. It is also called as **Theory of judgement**.
- It says that **all knowledge is relative, conditional and partial**, which logically implies that all our judgments are double-edged. According to this concept, identity and difference must exist in reality.

Hence, option C is correct.

Q63. Consider the following statements regarding Harsha's administration:

1. Harsha's administration was highly centralised.
2. The law and administration were well maintained.
3. No expenditure was allocated for religious purposes.
4. The maintenance of public records was the salient feature of Harsha's administration.

How many of the above statements is/are correct?

- A. Only one
- B. Only two
- C. Only three
- D. All four

Answer: A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is not correct: Harsha's administration was feudal and decentralised.** Harsha possessed huge army (100,000 horses and 60,000 elephants) because every feudatory contributed his quota of footmen and horses and thus made the imperial army vast in numbers.
- **Statement 2 is not correct: Hiuen Tsang who travelled in India between 628 A.D. and 645 A.D. during the reign of Harshavardhana, took note of untouchables as scavengers, executioners etc.** According to him, they lived outside the villages and consumed garlic and onion. The Untouchables announced their entry into the town or village by shouting loudly, so that the people might keep away from them.
 - **He described in the empire of Harsha law and order was not well-maintained.** The offenders were given physical punishments and tortured as well to extract

the truth from them while the traitors were given death sentence or turned out of the kingdom.

- **Statement 3 is not correct:** Harsha was a devout Buddhist and actively supported religious institutions and activities. **He allocated significant resources to monasteries, temples, and religious festivals.**
- **Statement 4 is correct:** Harsha placed strong emphasis on record-keeping. He maintained detailed accounts of revenue, expenditure, land grants, and other administrative matters.

Hence, option A is correct.

Q64. Consider the following statements with regards to Mohiniattam:

1. This dance style is predominantly a solo performance executed by male dancers.
2. It combines the grace and elegance of Bharatnatyam with the vigor of Kathakali.
3. It generally narrates the story of the feminine dance by Vishnu.

How many of the statements given above are **NOT** correct?

- A. Only one
- B. Only two
- C. All three
- D. None

Answer: A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is not correct:** Mohiniattam is a solo dance performance by women, developed and revived under the patronage of rulers like Swathi Thirunal and later by V. N. Menon and Kalyani Amma.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Mohiniattam blends the graceful elements of Bharatnatyam with the vigor found in Kathakali, resulting in a dance form that emphasizes elegance and gentle footwork.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Mohiniattam often tells the story of the feminine dance by Vishnu, incorporating mythological themes into its performances.

Hence, option A is correct.

Q65. Which of the following statements is/are correct regarding Sittanavasal Cave Paintings?

1. These cave paintings are located in Andhra Pradesh.
2. These caves are known for Buddhist Paintings.
3. They were constructed by the Mauryans.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- A. Only one
- B. Only two

- C. All three
- D. None

Answer: D

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is not correct:** Sittanavasal Cave (Arivar Koil) Paintings are located in **Tamil Nadu**. These famous rock-cut caves are known for the paintings in the Jain temples. **These murals have close resemblance to Bagh and Ajanta paintings. The paintings are not only on the walls but also on the ceiling and pillars.**
- **Statement 2 is not correct:** The paintings are with the theme of **Jain Samavasarana** (Preaching Hall).
- **Statement 3 is not correct:** Some scholars believe that these **caves belong to the Pallava period**, when king Mahendravarman-I excavated the temple, while the others attribute them to when Pandya ruler renovated the shrine in the 7th century.
 - The central element of the paintings in Sittanavasal is a pond with lotuses. **This scene shows Samava- Sarana** - important scene in Jain religion. Samava-Sarana is special, beautiful audience hall where Tirthankaras delivered sermons after they reached realisation (kevala gnana).

Hence, option D is correct.

Q66. Which of the following statements about sculptures at Sanchi is/are correct?

1. In some sculptures there is representation of Shalabhanjika.
2. The figure of Shalabhanjika is represented by a woman surrounded by lotuses and elephants.
3. The Shalabhanjika motif was not directly inspired by Buddhist ideas.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- A. 1, 2 and 3
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 2 only
- D. 1 and 3 only

Answer: D

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** In Buddhist art, **Shalabhanjika** means an image of a woman or yakshi next to, often holding, a tree, or a reference to Maya near the sala tree giving birth to Siddhartha (Buddha). The shalabhanjika on Sanchi Stupa holds the tree laden with fruits. Other figures included animals like elephants, horses, monkeys, and cattle.
- **Statement 2 is not correct:** The **motif of Gajalakshmi** in Sanchi stupa is surrounded by **lotuses and elephants**, which seems to be sprinkling water on her as if performing an Abhisheka or consecration. It is one of the earliest sculptures of Lakshmi.

- **Statement 3 is correct:** A scene is depicted at the **gateways of Sanchi stupa** as a scene from the **Vessantara Jataka**. Art historians often try to understand the meaning of sculpture by comparing it with textual evidence. Many symbols like empty seats, wheels, and trees were used to indicate the different teachings of Buddhism in Sanchi stupa. Other sculptures at Sanchi were perhaps not directly inspired by Buddhist ideas.

Hence, option D is correct.

Q67. Consider the following statements about the Mansabdari system:

1. The term Mansabdar refers to an individual who holds a rank in the Mughal administration.
2. The rank and salary of the Mansabdar were based on numerical value called as Zat.
3. All the Mansabdars resided in their Jagirs.

How many of the above statements is/are correct?

- A. Only one
- B. Only two
- C. All three
- D. None

Answer: B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** With the expansion of Mughal empire, the Mughals recruited diverse bodies of people. Those who joined the Mughal service were enrolled as the Mansabdars. The term **Mansabdar** refers to an **individual who holds a Mansab, meaning a position or a rank**.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** It was a **grading system** used by the Mughals to **fix the rank, salary and military responsibilities**. The rank and salary were determined by a numerical value, called Zat. The **higher the Zat, the more prestigious was the noble's position** in the court and the larger his salary.
- **Statement 3 is not correct:** The Mansabdars received their salaries as **revenue assignments**, called **Jagirs**, which were somewhat like the Iqtas. But unlike the Muqtis, most **Mansabdars did not actually reside in or administer their Jagirs**. They **only had rights to the revenue of their assignments, which was collected for them by their servants**, while the Mansabdars themselves served in some other part of the country. While majority of mansabdars received jagirs, some of them were **paid in cash** and thus called as **Naqdi mansabdars**.

Hence, option B is correct.

Q68. Consider the following statements about the Satavahana dynasty:

1. The founder of the Satavahana dynasty was Simuka.
2. Gautamiputra Satakarni patronized Brahmanism.
3. Satavahana sculptures at Amravati reflect the influence of both the Gandhara and the Mathura School of Art.

How many of the above statements is/are correct?

- A. Only one
- B. Only two
- C. All three
- D. None

Answer: C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** In the Deccan, the Satavahana established their independent rule after the decline of the Mauryas. They were also known as the **Andhras**. **The founder of the Satavahana dynasty was Simuka.**
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The **greatest ruler of the Satavahana dynasty was Gautamiputra Satakarni**. He ruled for a period of 24 years, from 106 A.D. to 130 A.D. His achievements were recorded in the **Nasik inscription** by his mother Gautami Balasri. **He patronized Brahmanism.** While Gautamiputra Satakarni maintained and supported the existing Brahmanical structures, **he also actively supported Buddhism**, as evidenced by his involvement in the construction of stupas and excavations at Amaravati and Nagarjunakonda.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** The **Satavahana sculptures at Amaravati** reflect the influence of **both the Gandhara and the Mathura school of Art**. Eroticism is also a predominant feature of these Satavahana sculptures. Spontaneous energy, grace, and dynamism ooze out of the carved stone figures.

Hence, option C is correct.

Q69. With reference to 15th century India, consider the following statements:

1. Mahmud Begarha, ruler of Gujarat founded town known as Mustafabad.
2. Malik Muhammad Jaisi, the author of Padmavat, lived in Rajasthan.
3. Zainul Abidin abolished Jaziya and was called as 'Akbar of Kashmir'.

How many of the above statements is/are correct?

- A. Only one
- B. Only two
- C. All three
- D. None

Answer: B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Mahmud Begarha, ruler of Gujarat founded town known as **Mustafabad**. He was called as **Begarha** because he captured two important forts (garhs) – **Girnar** in Saurashtra and **Champaner** in south Gujarat.
- **Statement 2 is not correct:** Jaunpur ('Shiraz of the east') was the **prosperous kingdom in eastern part** of Delhi Sultanate. **Malik Sawar** was the governor of **Jaunpur** and got the title of "**Sultanu Sharq**" (Master of East). After Timur invasion, Malik Sawar took the advantage of situation and declared independence. **Malik Muhammad Jaisi**, the author of **Padmavat**, lived in **Jaunpur**.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** **Zainul Abidin** ruled from 1420 to 1470. He stopped atrocities on non-muslims, abolished Jizyah, and brought back the Hindus who had fled from Kashmir during previous rules. He contributed to agricultural development of Kashmir by constructing dams and canals.

Hence, option B is correct.

Q70. Consider the following statements with respect to the reign of King Amoghavarsha:

1. This period shows the rise of regional languages, such as Kannada.
2. Mahaviracharya, who wrote Ganita-sara-Samgrah, lived during the reign of Amoghavarsha.
3. Amoghavarsha himself contributed to the book Kavirajamarga.
4. He was an ardent follower of Buddhism.

How many of the above statements is/are correct?

- A. Only one
- B. Only two
- C. Only three
- D. All four

Answer: C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Amoghavarsha I was a **Rashtrakuta** emperor, the greatest ruler of the Rashtrakuta dynasty, and one of the great emperors of India. Many Kannada and Sanskrit scholars prospered during his rule.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Great Indian mathematician, **Mahaviracharya**, who wrote **Ganita-Sara-Samgraha** lived during the reign of Amoghavarsha. **Jinasena**, **Virasena**, **Shakatayan** and **Sri Vijaya** (a Kannada language theorist) prospered during his rule.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Amoghavarsha I was an **accomplished poet and scholar**. He wrote (or co-authored) the **Kavirajamarga**, the earliest extant literary work in **Kannada**, and **Prashnottara Ratnamalika**, a religious work in **Sanskrit**.
- **Statement 4 is not correct:** He was **converted to Jainism** by **Jinasena** (Jaina monk and author of Adipurana).

Hence, option C is correct.

Q71. With reference to the Imperial Chola dynasty, consider the following statements:

1. The famous Uttaramerur inscriptions belong to the reign of Parantaka I.
2. The Cholas invaded and conquered northern Sri Lanka during the reign of Rajendra I.
3. The famous Brihadeshwara Temple was built by Rajaraja I.
4. The title of Gangaikondan was assumed by Rajendra I.

How many of the above statements is/are correct?

- A. Only one
- B. Only two
- C. Only three
- D. All four

Answer: C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The **Uttaramerur Inscriptions** was famous for detailing the existence of autonomous village assemblies (a rare example of local governance in early medieval India). It belonged to the reign of Chola ruler **Parantaka I**. He was one of the important early Chola rulers.
- **Statement 2 is not correct:** The **Cholas invaded and conquered northern Sri Lanka during the reign of Rajaraja I**. The expedition was led on ground by his son, and the then crown prince Rajendra I. Later after ascending the throne, Rajendra I crushed a rebellion by the Sri Lankan ruler Mahinda V, and he annexed the entire Sri Lanka in the battle that he won consequently.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** The **Brihadeshwara Temple**, dedicated to **Lord Shiva**, was built under the patronage of **Rajaraja I** in 1010 CE. It was also called **Rajarajeswara Temple** in his honour.
- **Statement 4 is correct:** Rajendra I led a successful expedition to North India, defeating several rulers along the way. Under his leadership the Chola army crossed the Ganges and defeated Mahipala I of Bengal. To mark his extraordinary feat, **Rajendra I assumed the title of Gangaikondan** (i.e. the Chola who has defeated kings across the Ganga). He also founded the city of **Gangaikondacholapuram** to commemorate this victory

Hence, option C is correct.

Q72. It is one of the earliest surviving brick temples of India. It is the oldest remaining terracotta Hindu shrine with a roof and a high Shikhara which paved the way for elaborate Nagara style of temple architecture in North India. The entrance into the sanctum shows one of the first uses of a semi-circular doorway. Alexander Cunningham called this as the 'Hindu arch' which was peculiar to India.

The above paragraph refers to which one of the following?

- A. Bhitargaon Temple, (Kanpur) Uttar Pradesh.

- B. Mundeshwari Devi Temple, Bihar
- C. Parvati temple (Nachna Kuthara), Madhya Pradesh
- D. The Dashavatara Temple, (Deogarh) Uttar Pradesh

Answer: A

Explanation:

- **Bhitargaon temple** in Uttar Pradesh was made of **baked brick and stone**. It is one of the **earliest surviving brick temples of India**. It was built in the 5th century A.D during the **Gupta Empire**.
- It is the **oldest remaining terracotta Hindu shrine** with a roof and a high Shikhara (spire) which paved the way for elaborate Nagara style of temple architecture in North India. The entrance into the sanctum shows one of the first uses of a **semi-circular doorway**. Alexander Cunningham (First Director General of the Archaeological Survey of India, 1871) called this as the '**Hindu arch**' which was peculiar to India. The temple has a **tall pyramidal** (shikhara) above the **inner sanctum (garbhagriha)**.
- This shikhara became the standard feature of the Nagara temple architecture of India. The walls of the temple are decorated with **terracotta sculptures of God and Goddesses like Shiva, Parvati, Ganesha, Vishnu** etc.

Hence, option A is correct.

Q73. With reference to the institution of marriage in the post-Mauryan phase, which of the following statements are **NOT** correct?

1. Dharmashastras and Dharmasutras recognised eight forms of marriages.
2. After marriage, women retained their father's gotra.
3. Marriages were not allowed in the same gotra.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- A. 2 only
- B. 1 and 2 only
- C. 3 only
- D. 1 and 3 only

Answer: A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Dharmashastras and Dharmasutras, ancient legal and social texts, **recognize eight forms of marriage**, including **Gandharva** (love marriage), **Brahma** (arranged marriage), and **Asura** (marriage by capture) etc.
- **Statement 2 is not correct:** After marriage, **women typically adopted their husband's gotra** (not their father's gotra). Gotra is a patrilineal lineage system, and marriage traditionally signified a woman's transition into her husband's family.

- **Statement 3 is correct:** Marriages within the same gotra were prohibited to avoid incestuous relationships.

Hence, option A is correct.

Q74. With reference to Bihu dance, consider the following statements:

1. It is primarily performed in Assam.
2. It involves slow and graceful movements.
3. In Bihu dance, the performers use swords and spears.
4. It is exclusively performed by women.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2, 3 and 4 only
- C. 1 and 3 only
- D. 1 and 4 only

Answer: A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct: Bihu is a traditional dance of Assam.** Both men and women participate in this joyous dance during festivals, adorned in vibrant traditional attire. It symbolizes the cultural essence of Assam, fostering community spirit through collective performances.
- **Statement 2 is not correct:** Bihu is known for its **energetic and lively choreography**. Dancers engage in **rapid hand movements and brisk footsteps**, creating a dynamic and festive atmosphere during the performance.
- **Statement 3 is not correct: Bihu dance is a celebration dance, not a martial art.** It emphasizes cultural expression and joyous festivities, with **no involvement of swords or spears**.
- **Statement 4 is not correct:** Bihu is a dance form **inclusive of both genders**. **Men and women join together in groups to perform Bihu**, showcasing unity and collective celebration. The dance reflects the diversity and harmony within Assam's cultural heritage.

Hence, option A is correct.

Q75. With reference to Palaeolithic age, consider the following statements:

1. It spans nearly 50% of human history.
2. Bone tools were found, but stone tools were not made in this period.
3. Evidence of the existence of ostriches were found in India during this period.
4. There were few climatic changes in this period with only one inter-glacial period leading to a largely stable environment.

How many of the above statements is/are correct?

- A. Only one
- B. Only two
- C. Only three
- D. All four

Answer: A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is not correct:** The Palaeolithic period extends from 2 million years ago to about 12,000 years ago. This long stretch of time is divided into the Lower, Middle and Upper Palaeolithic. This long span of time covers 99% of human history.
- **Statement 2 is not correct:** The Palaeolithic Age is characterized by the use of knapped stone tools, although at the time humans also used wood and bone tools. Stone tools were also found during this period are generally tiny, and are called microliths. Microliths were probably stuck on to handles of bone or wood to make tools such as saws and sickles.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Ostriches were found in India during the Palaeolithic period. Large quantities of ostrich egg shells were found at Patne in Maharashtra. Designs were engraved on some pieces, while beads were also made out of them.
- **Statement 4 is not correct:** The period when we find environmental changes, beginning about 12,000 years ago till about 10,000 years ago is called the Mesolithic (middle stone). The climate during the Palaeolithic Age consisted of a set of glacial and interglacial periods in which the climate periodically fluctuated between warm and cool temperatures.

Hence, option A is correct.

Q76. Consider the following statements regarding Alexander's Invasion of the Indian subcontinent:

1. Alexander's army entered Indian subcontinent through Gomal pass.
2. Ambhi, the ruler of Taxila gave the first major resistance to the Alexander's army.
3. Alexander had captured areas till the Ganga Yamuna Doab.

Which of the above statement is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. 2 and 3 only
- D. None of the above

Answer: D

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is not correct:** Alexander entered through Khyber Pass in 326 B.C. , located in the northwest of the Indian subcontinent (present-day Pakistan and Afghanistan). It was a strategically important mountain pass that connected Central Asia to the Indian subcontinent.
- **Statement 2 is not correct:** Ambhi, the ruler of Taxila, actually submitted to Alexander without offering significant resistance. The first major resistance was encountered during the Battle of the Hydaspes River against King Porus.
- **Statement 3 is not correct:** Alexander's conquests in the Indian subcontinent **did not extend to the Ganga Yamuna Doab**. After the Battle of the Hydaspes, his troops were exhausted, and the soldiers expressed a desire to return home. Consequently, Alexander turned back and did not venture further east into the Ganga plain. Alexander had moved only till **Beas** River.

Hence, option D is correct.

Q77. Consider the following statements:

1. The Mughal paintings reached its zenith in the period of Akbar.
2. Jahangir shifted from illustrated manuscripts to albums and emphasized bringing naturalism to portrait painting.
3. Akbar established a formal artistic studio called Tasvir Khana where artists were hired on salary, and they developed their own styles.

How many of the above statements are **NOT** correct?

- A. Only one
- B. Only two
- C. All three
- D. None

Answer: A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is not correct:** Under **Jahangir's patronage**, **Mughal paintings achieved unparalleled heights**, marked by a **blend of naturalistic themes and intricate details**, setting a pinnacle in artistic expression during the Mughal era.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Jahangir's artistic preferences led to a **shift in focus from manuscripts to albums**, emphasizing the portrayal of flora, fauna, and naturalism in individual portraits, contributing to the evolution of Mughal artistic traditions.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** **Tasvir Khana, under Akbar's patronage, became a structured artistic hub** where painters received salaries, fostering the development of individual artistic styles within the Mughal artistic tradition.

Hence, option A is correct.

Q78. Consider the following statements:

Statement-I:

The middle of the sixth century AD witnessed the decline of trade between India and the Eastern Roman Empire.

Statement-II:

Around 550 AD, the people of Eastern Roman Empire learnt the art of growing silk from the Chinese.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

- A. Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II is the correct explanation for Statement-I.
- B. Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II is not the correct explanation for Statement-I.
- C. Statement-I is correct but Statement-II is incorrect.
- D. Statement-I is incorrect but Statement-II is correct.

Answer: A

Explanation:

- **Statement-I is correct:** Middle of the 6th century (around 500-550 AD) saw a decline in trade between India and the Eastern Roman Empire. **Several factors contributed to this:**
 - **Political instability:** Both empires faced internal and external pressures (Huna invasion), leading to reduced resources for trade ventures.
 - **Rise of Persia:** The Sasanian Empire of Persia became a strong regional power, disrupting trade routes between India and the Roman world.
 - **Epidemics:** The Justinian Plague and other outbreaks hindered trade and travel.
- **Statement-II is correct:** Around 550 AD, the **Eastern Roman Empire acquired the knowledge of silk production from the Chinese.** This led to the establishment of their own silk industry, **reducing their dependence on imported luxury goods from India. It adversely affected Indian trade with Roman Empire.**

Hence, option A is correct.

Q79. Consider the following statements about Sulh-i kul (Akbar's principle):

1. It focused on a system of ethics, honesty, justice, peace that was universally applicable.
2. Abul Fazl helped Akbar in framing a vision of governance around this idea of Sulh-i kul.
3. This principle of governance was followed by Jahangir and Aurangzeb as well.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1 and 2 only
- D. 1 and 3 only

Answer: C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Akbar's interaction with the people of different faiths made him realise that the religious scholars, who emphasised ritual and dogma, were often bigots. Their teachings created divisions and disharmony amongst their subjects. This eventually led Akbar to the **idea of Sulh-i kul** or "**universal peace**". This idea of tolerance did not discriminate between the people of different religions in his realm. Instead, it focused on a system of ethics – honesty, justice, peace – that was universally applicable.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Abul Fazl helped Akbar in framing a vision of governance around this idea of Sulh-i kul. Akbar, recognizing the diversity of his empire and the presence of various religious communities, sought to create an inclusive and tolerant society.
- **Statement 3 is not correct:** This principle of governance was followed by **Jahangir** and **Shah jahan** (not Aurangzeb) as well.

Hence, option C is correct.

Q80. Consider the following statements regarding Iltutmish:

1. The hereditary succession to the Delhi Sultanate was initiated by Iltutmish.
2. He patronized scholars like Minhaj-us Siraj and Nizam-ul-mulk Muhammad Junaidi.
3. He was the first Delhi sultan to introduce the Arabic coins in India.

How many of the above statements is/are correct?

- A. Only one
- B. Only two
- C. All three
- D. None

Answer: C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Iltutmish was a great statesman. He received the Mansur, the letter of recognition, from the Abbasid Caliph in 1229, by which he became the legal sovereign ruler of India. Later, **he nominated his daughter Raziya as his successor. Thus, the hereditary succession to the Delhi Sultanate was initiated by Iltutmish.**
- **Statement 2 is correct:** He patronized many scholars and a number Sufi saints came to India during his reign. **Minhaj-us-Siraj, Taj-ud-din, Nizam-ul-mulk Muhammad Junaidi, Malik Qutb-ud-din Hasan and Fakhru-Mulk Isami** were his contemporary scholars who added grandeur to his court. Apart from completing the construction of Qutb Minar at Delhi, the tallest stone tower in India (238 ft.), he built a magnificent mosque at Ajmer.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Iltutmish was the **first Delhi sultan** to introduce the **Arabic coinage into India** and the **Silver Tanka weighing 175 grams became a standard coin in medieval India.** The Silver Tanka remained the basis of the modern Rupee. Iltutmish had also created a new class of ruling elite of 40 powerful military leaders, the Forty.

Hence, option C is correct.

Q81. The characteristic feature of the Mauryan pottery was:

- A. Painted Grey Ware
- B. Northern Black Polished Ware
- C. Ochre Colored Pottery
- D. Black and Red Ware

Answer: B

Explanation:

- **Northern Black Polished Ware (NBPW)** was the characteristic feature of **Mauryan pottery**.
- **Megasthenes has mentioned in high praise the skill shown by artisans of Pataliputra palace.** They show high technical skills attained by them.
- The **polishing of stone pillars, which are known as Northern Black Polished Ware are still found in sites of Mauryan Empire.** There are sculptures of peacock, bulls or lions made of them. NBPW was characteristic feature of Mahajanapada period as well.

Hence, option B is correct.

Q82. He was a well-known Chinese traveler who came to India around 1400 years ago to visit places associated with the life of the Buddha as well as famous monasteries. He studied in Nalanda, (Bihar) the most famous Buddhist monastery of that period. He took the land route back to China (through the north-west, and Central Asia) carried back with him statues of the Buddha and spent the rest of his life translating the remaining manuscripts from Sanskrit into Chinese. The traveler whose reference is given above was:

- A. Fa Hian
- B. Taizong of Tang
- C. Hiuen Tsang
- D. I-Qing

Answer: C

Explanation:

Various Chinese Buddhist pilgrims came to India.

- Fa Hian came to the subcontinent about 1600 years ago, Hiuen Tsang who came around 1400 years ago and I-Qing, who came about 50 years after Hiuen Tsang. They came to visit places associated with the life of the Buddha as well as famous monasteries. Each of these pilgrims left an account of his journey.
- **Hiuen Tsang, who took the land route back to China (through the north-west, and Central Asia) carried back with him statues of the Buddha made of gold, silver and sandalwood,** and over 600 manuscripts loaded on the backs of 20 horses. Over 50 manuscripts were lost when the boat on which he was crossing the Indus capsized. He spent the rest of his life

translating the remaining manuscripts from sanskrit into chinese. Hiuen Tsang, and other pilgrims spent time studying in Nalanda, (Bihar) the most famous Buddhist monastery of the period.

Hence, option C is correct.

Q83. Who among the following saints were contemporaries of Mughal king Akbar?

1. Sri Chaitanya
2. Nizamuddin Auliya
3. Tulsidas
4. Sain Mian Mir
5. Guru Nanak Dev

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- A. 1, 2 and 3 only
- B. 1, 2 and 5 only
- C. 3 and 4 only
- D. 1, 3, 4 and 5 only

Answer: C

Explanation:

Akbar was born in **1542** and died in **1605**. He reigned from 1556 to 1605 and extended Mughal power over most of the Indian subcontinent. Of the above given saints, only **Tulsidas and Sain Mian Mir were the contemporaries of Akbar.**

- **Chaitanya Mahaprabhu (1485–1534)** advocated the pursuit of mystical devotion through repetitive chanting, especially of the Hare Krishna mantra.
- **Nizamuddin Auliya** was born in 1238 AD in Uttar. He went to Ajodhan to become a disciple of the Sufi saint Fariduddin Ganjshakar, also known as Baba Farid.
- **Tulsidas** was born in 1532 and died in 1623. He was an **Vaishnavite poet** whose principal work in Awadhi, Ramcharitmanas, remains the most-popular version of the story of Rama. Raheem and Tulsidas both were Awadhi poets, **contemporary of Akbar.**
- **Mir Mohammed Muayyinul Islam (1550-1635)** popularly known as **Sain Mian Mir** was a famous Muslim Sufi saint who resided in Lahore. He belonged to the Qadiri order of Sufism. Mian Mir laid the foundation stone of Golden Temple whose land was donated by Akbar.
- **Guru Nanak Dev was contemporary of Babur (not of Akbar).**

Hence, option C is correct.

Q84. In context of 'Vijayanagara Empire', consider the following statements:

1. The Amara-nayakas were military commanders who were given territories to govern by the Raya.
2. Many features of Amara-nayakas system were derived from the Portuguese system of feudal governance.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The **Amara-nayakas** were **military commanders** who were given territories to govern by the Raya. Kings occasionally asserted their control over them by transferring them from one place to another. However, during the course of the seventeenth century, many of these nayakas established independent kingdoms.
- **Statement 2 is not correct:** The Amara-nayaka system was a **major political innovation of the Vijayanagara Empire**. It is likely that many features of this system were derived from the **Iqta system of the Delhi Sultanate**. Under Iqta System, the land of the empire was divided into several large and small tracts called Iqta and assigned these Iqtas to his soldiers, officers and nobles.

Hence, option A is correct.

Q85. The famous sculptures of Ardhanarishvara and Maheshamurti are found at

- A. Elephanta caves
- B. Bhagh caves
- C. Udayagiri caves
- D. Ajanta caves

Answer: A

Explanation:

- The **Elephanta caves** is a group of caves located near **Mumbai**. It was declared a world heritage site by UNESCO in 1987. Known locally as **Gharapuri Caves**, these were constructed around the 5th - 6th centuries AD.
- **Ardhanarishvara** and **Maheshamurti** are the **famous sculptures found in the Elephanta caves**. The Elephanta Caves were originally a Buddhist site which was later dominated by the Shaivite faith. It is **contemporary with Ellora**, and its sculptures show slenderness in the body, with stark light and dark effects.

Hence, option A is correct.

Q86. Consider the following pairs with reference to poet and their contemporary kings:

Poet	Contemporary kings
1. Banabhatta	Samudragupta
2. Harishena	Harshavardhana
3. Ravikirti	Pulakeshin II

Which of the above pairs is/are correctly matched?

- A. 2 only
- B. 1 and 3 only
- C. 1, 2 and 3
- D. 3 only

Answer: D

Explanation:

- **Pair 1 is not correct:** Harishena (and not Banabhatta) was the contemporary of Samudragupta. Samudragupta was known from a long inscription, inscribed on the Ashokan pillar at Allahabad. It was composed as a Kavya by Harishena, who was a poet and a minister at the court of Samudragupta.
- **Pair 2 is not correct:** Banabhatta (and not Harishena) was the contemporary of Harshavardhana. He was the court poet of Harshavardhana and wrote his biography, the Harshacharita in Sanskrit.
- **Pair 3 is correct:** Pulakeshin II was the best-known Chalukya ruler. A prashasti was composed by his court poet Ravikirti. This tells us about his ancestors, who are traced back through four generations from father to son. Pulakeshin evidently got the kingdom from his uncle. According to Ravikirti, he led expeditions along both the west and the east coasts.

Hence, option D is correct.

Q87. In ancient history of India, the term 'Prashasti' refers to

- A. Land given to Brahmana.
- B. Pure Gold coins.
- C. Colleges generally attached to the temples.
- D. Inscriptions praising the rulers.

Answer: D

Explanation:

- **Prashastis** are special kind of inscriptions and is a Sanskrit word which means "in praise for". It contains details about the ruler who ruled at that point of time.
- They were written in Sanskrit or any regional language. Prashastis tells us how the rulers wanted themselves to be depicted, i.e. victorious, achievers, valiant warriors etc.
- An example of prashasti is a Sanskrit poem written by Harishena in praise of the King Samudragupta. This poem was composed 1700 years ago and is inscribed on the Ashoka

pillars in Allahabad. It tells us about the nine Aryavarta rulers that were uprooted by Samudragupta.

Hence, option D is correct.

Q88. With respect to the major tenets of Jainism, consider the following statements:

1. It allowed the practice of agriculture.
2. It followed the philosophy of Anekantavada.
3. According to Jainism, man is the creator of his own destiny.

How many of the above statements is/are correct?

- A. Only one
- B. Only two
- C. All three
- D. None

Answer: B

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is not correct:** Jainism prescribed that worshipper should feed cooked food to the needy every day. He preached that **lay worshipper should not take to agriculture**, since this involved the **destruction of plants and insects**. Therefore, it **prohibited the practice of agriculture**.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** **Anekantavada is one of the most important and fundamental doctrines of Jainism**. It refers to the **principles of pluralism and multiplicity of viewpoints**, the notion that truth and reality are perceived differently from diverse points of view, and that no single point of view is the complete truth.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** According to Jainism, **man is the creator of his own destiny** and he could **attain 'moksha' by pursuing a life of purity, virtue and renunciation**.
- Moksha can be attained by observing the following **three principles (ratnatraya)**: Right belief, Right knowledge, Right action.

Hence, option B is correct.

Q89. Hiuen Tsang portrays the social life in the times of Harsha. In this context consider the following statements:

1. He mentions that certain privileged sections of society received land grants from kings.
2. He mentions that the Sudras practiced agriculture.
3. He notes that women enjoyed high status in literary societies and remarriage of widows was permitted.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 3 only

- C. 1 and 2 only
- D. 2 and 3 only

Answer: C

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Hiuen Tsang mention fourfold division of the society – Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vysya and Sudra – was prevalent. **The Brahmins were the privileged section of the society and they were given land grants by the kings.**
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Hiuen Tsang mentions that the Sudras practiced agriculture. His writings indicate that Sudras, falling at the lower end of the caste hierarchy, were primarily engaged in agriculture and other manual labor.
- **Statement 3 is not correct:** The **position of women was not satisfactory.** The institution of **Swyamvara** (the choice of choosing her husband) **had declined. Remarriage of widows was not permitted**, particularly among the higher castes. The **system of dowry** had also become common. The **practice of sati was also prevalent.**

Hence, option C is correct.

Q90. Which of the following systems were popularly introduced by Alauddin Khilji?

1. Branding of horses
2. Maintaining a descriptive list of soldiers
3. Paying army in kind rather than cash
4. Market based pricing for all products

Select the correct answer using the codes below:

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2, 3 and 4 only
- C. 1 and 4 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3 only

Answer: A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Alauddin Khilji implemented a system where horses in the army were branded (**Dagh System**). This involved marking the horses with a specific symbol or sign, which helped in identifying and keeping track of the horses. This practice was crucial for maintaining a well-organized and efficient cavalry, as it ensured that the soldiers had reliable and identifiable horses.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Alauddin Khilji established a **comprehensive system of recording detailed information about each soldier in the army (Huliya System)**. This included not just their names, but also their skills, capabilities, and other relevant details. This detailed list allowed the administration to better understand the strengths

and weaknesses of the military personnel and deploy them strategically based on their skills and expertise.

- **Statement 3 is not correct:** Alauddin Khilji maintained a large permanent standing army and paid them in cash from the royal treasury. In order to ensure maximum efficiency, a strict review of army from time to time was carried out.
- **Statement 4 is not correct:** The introduction of paying salaries in cash to the soldiers led to price regulations popularly called as Market Reforms. Markets were under the control of a high officer called Shahna-i-Mandi. The supply of grain was ensured by holding stocks in government store-houses. Regulations were issued to fix the price of all commodities.

Hence, option A is correct.

Q91. Consider the following statements regarding Dravidian style of temple architecture:

1. They are enclosed within a compound wall.
2. At the entrance of the Garbhagriha, the temple is guarded by mithunas and the river goddesses Ganga and Yamuna.
3. Multiple shikharas are found in these types of temples.

How many of the above statements is/are correct?

- A. Only one
- B. Only two
- C. All three
- D. None

Answer: A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Unlike the Nagara temple, the Dravida temple is enclosed within a compound wall, Prakota. The front wall has an entrance gateway in its centre, which is known as gopuram. The shape of the main temple tower, known as vimana in Tamil Nadu, is like a stepped pyramid that rises up geometrically rather than the curving shikhara of North India.
- **Statement 2 is not correct:** At the entrance of the North Indian temple's garbhagriha, it would be usual to find images such as mithunas and river goddesses Ganga and Yamuna. In the temples of south, Dvarapalas or the door keepers guards the temple.
- **Statement 3 is not correct:** Subsidiary shrines are either incorporated within the main temple tower or located as distinct, separate small shrines beside the main temple. The North Indian idea of multiple shikharas rising together as a cluster was not popular in South India.

Hence, option A is correct.

Q92. With reference to the Bahmani kingdom, consider the following statements:

1. The kingdom was divided into number of provinces called 'Tarafs'.
2. Mansabdari system was prevalent wherein the military officers were assigned jagirs according to their mansabs.
3. In every province, Khalisa lands were set apart for the expenses of the sultan.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Mahmud Gawan divided the kingdom into **eight provinces or tarafs**. Each **taraf** was governed by a **tarafdar**. The salaries and obligations of each noble were fixed. The salary could be **paid in cash or by assigning a jagir**.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Shihabuddin Ahmad I introduced **Mansabdari system** in the **army** wherein the **military officers were assigned jagirs according to their mansabs** or ranks to meet the expenses of the armies raised by them. The civilian officers were also assigned mansabs with a view to fix up their salaries.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** In every province, **Khalisa lands was set apart for the expenses of the sultan**. Efforts were made to measure the land and to fix the amount to be paid by the cultivator to the state.

Hence, option D is correct.

Q93. With reference to the Shivaji's rule during 17th century, consider the following statements:

1. The revenue system was reformed and lands were measured by using the measuring rod called kathi.
2. The landlords like deshmuks and kulkarnis became powerful under Shivaji.
3. Shivaji made the Peshwa office hereditary in nature.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 3 only
- C. 1 and 2 only
- D. 2 and 3 only

Answer: A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Most of the administrative reforms of Shivaji were based on the practices of the Deccan sultanate. Lands were measured by using the measuring rod called

kathi. Lands were also classified into three categories – paddy fields, garden lands and hilly tracks.

- **Statement 2 is not correct:** Shivaji reduced the powers of the existing deshmuks and kulkarnis who were the landlords. He appointed his own revenue officials called karkuns to ensure proper estimation of land revenue.
- **Statement 3 is not correct:** Ashtapradhan included Peshwa, Mazumdar (auditor), Wakinavis (incharge of king's private officers), Dabirs (foreign secretary), Surnis (superintendent), Panditrao (Ecclesiastical head), Senapati (commander in chief), Nyayadhish (Chief Justice). These offices were neither hereditary nor permanent. They held office till the king's pleasure and they were frequently transferred. They were directly paid by exchequer and no jagir was granted to any civil or military officer.

Hence, option A is correct.

Q94. Consider the following statements with reference to the Indo-Greeks:

1. The weakness of Seleucid empire of Bactria and Parthia was one of the reasons behind Greek invasion in India.
2. The first coins to bear the names and images of rulers were issued by the Indo-Greeks.

Which of the above statements is/are **NOT** correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: D

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The first to cross Hindukush were the Greeks, who ruled Bactria, lying in North Afghanistan. **One important cause of invasions was the weakness of the Seleucid empire which had been established in Bactria and the adjoining areas of Iran called Parthia.** Due to the Scythian tribes the later Greeks were unable to hold their power in this area. So, they turned to invade India.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** **The first coins to bear the names and images of rulers were issued by the Indo Greeks.** They established control over the north-western part of the subcontinent in second century BCE.

Hence, option D is correct.

Q95. Consider the following statements regarding Madhubani Paintings:

1. These paintings often depict religious motifs and puranic deities.
2. In these Paintings, figures such as fish are symbolic, representing good luck and fertility.
3. These Paintings are three-dimensional due to the shading techniques used.

How many of the above statements are **NOT** correct?

- A. Only one
- B. Only two
- C. All three
- D. None

Answer: A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Madhubani Paintings, synonymous with Mithila Paintings, are celebrated for their depiction of Hindu religious motifs. These include revered deities such as **Krishna, Rama, Durga, Lakshmi, and Shiva**. The art form serves as a visual medium to convey mythological stories and cultural narratives through vibrant colors, intricate patterns, and symbolic imagery, capturing the essence of devotion and spirituality.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Within the rich symbolism of Madhubani Paintings, figures like the fish carry profound meanings. **The fish, in particular, symbolizes positive elements such as good luck and fertility**. Each element within Madhubani art is carefully chosen to convey cultural significance, making the paintings not just aesthetically pleasing but also laden with cultural and symbolic depth.
- **Statement 3 is not correct:** Madhubani Paintings are renowned for their distinctive two-dimensional aesthetic. Unlike some other art forms that employ shading techniques to create a sense of depth, **Madhubani Paintings embrace a flat, symbolic style**. The absence of shading emphasizes bold colors, intricate patterns, and exaggerated features, contributing to the unique visual language of this traditional art form.

Hence, option A is correct.

Q96. Consider the following statements:

Statement-I:

Balban made his government firm, stable and centralised all authority in his hands.

Statement-II:

He wanted to protect the North-West frontier against Mongol invasions.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

- A. Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II is the correct explanation for Statement-I.
- B. Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II is not the correct explanation for Statement-I.
- C. Statement-I is correct but Statement-II is incorrect.
- D. Statement-I is incorrect but Statement-II is correct.

Answer: B

Explanation:

- **Statement-I is correct: Balban made his government firm, stable and centralised all authority in his hands. It is because he was mindful of the intrigues of nobles, who wanted to continue their power and influence in the court, even at the expense of the king.** It was an age in which the authority and power was supposed to be the privilege of those born in noble houses and this was also one of the reasons for concentrating powers in his hands.
- **Statement-II is correct: He wanted to protect the North-West frontier against Mongol invasions as they were posing threat through North-West frontier.** Although, he fought against the Mongols stoutly, the frontiers of Delhi gradually receded from the river Jhelum to the Beas.

Hence, option B is correct.

Q97. In Medieval India, the designations 'Mahattara' and 'Pattakila' were used for

- A. Military officers
- B. Village headmen
- C. Specialists in Vedic rituals
- D. Chiefs of craft guilds

Answer: B

Explanation:

- **Mahattara** refers to “**representatives of towns or villages**” and was a title used in the administration during the rule of the **Silahara dynasty** (765-1215 AD).
- **Pattakila** was the term used for **village headmen** in Medieval India.
- A **village headman** is the community leader of a village or a small town. He performs various duties in the village and acts as a **dispute resolver or mediator** in resolving disputes relating to the village or individuals.

Hence, option B is correct.

Q98. Consider the following events in the medieval history of India:

1. Battle of Kanauj
2. First Battle of Panipat
3. First expedition of Vasco da Gama to India
4. Battle of Talikota

What is the correct chronological order of the above events?

- A. 4-1-2-3
- B. 2-4-3-1
- C. 3-2-1-4
- D. 4-2-1-3

Answer: C

Explanation:

- **First expedition of Vasco da Gama to India (1497):** Vasco da Gama was a Portuguese navigator who, in 1497-9, sailed around the Cape of Good Hope in southern Africa and arrived at Calicut (now Kozhikode) on the south-west coast of India. This was the first direct voyage from Portugal to India and allowed the Europeans to cut in on the immensely lucrative Eastern trade in spices.
- **First Battle of Panipat (1526):** After ascending the throne of Ferghana in 1494, Babur faced revolt from his own family and relatives. In 1497, he conquered Samarkand but lost the city of Ferghana soon after that. In 1525, Babur with Humayun his eldest son set out on invading India against Ibrahim Lodhi. In 1526, **Babur defeated Ibrahim Lodi in the First Battle of Panipat (1526)** and founded the Mughal empire.
- **Battle of Kanauj (1540):** The Battle of Kanauj took place between Sher Shah Suri and Humayun in 1540. This battle is also known as the battle of Bilgram. Humayun was defeated by Sher Shah Suri in this battle.
- **Battle of Talikota (1565):** The Battle of Talikota (23 January 1565) was a **watershed battle fought between the Vijayanagara Empire and an alliance of the Deccan sultanates**. This battle is also known as **Raksasa Thangadi**. Rama Raya was imprisoned and executed. The city of Vijayanagar was destroyed.

Hence, option C is correct.

Q99. Which of the following statements regarding the Vakataka dynasty is correct?

- A. They succeeded the Sunga dynasty in Eastern Indian region.
- B. Unlike their contemporaries, they did not award any land grants.
- C. They withdrew support from non-Brahmanical religions like Buddhism and Jainism.
- D. They had matrimonial alliances with the Gupta dynasty.

Answer: D

Explanation:

- **Option A is not correct:** The **Vakatakas succeeded the Satavahana** (not Sunga) dynasty in the Vidarbha (Maharashtra) & Berar (not Eastern Indian) region.
- **Option B is not correct:** The **Vakatakas continued the Satavahana and Gupta practice of awarding land grants** with certain rights (like abolition of taxation, control over labour, resources, etc) - **Pariharas**. These **land grants were made mostly to the Brahmins** so that they may increase the area under agriculture and legitimise the new dynasty's rule by incorporating the newer outside elements into the society under the kings.
- **Option C is not correct:** The Vakatakas themselves were **Brahmins** and **supported orthodox Brahmanical religion**. They were liberal and tolerant and towards other religions too. They continued to patronize **Buddhism**.

- **Option D is correct:** The Vakatakas were contemporaneous with the Guptas and were known for their **matrimonial alliances with the Guptas**. The most famous of these matrimonial alliances was that between **Rudrasena II** of Vakataka dynasty with **Prabhavatigupta** (daughter of Chandragupta II) of the Gupta dynasty.

Hence, option D is correct.

Q100. With reference to the Tughlaq rule, consider the following statements:

1. Diwan-i-Kohi was created to boost the military power of the empire.
2. Iqtadari system was discontinued during the rule of Firoz Shah Tughlaq.
3. A system of canal and irrigation was extended during the Tughlaq rule.

How many of the above statements is/are correct?

- A. Only one
- B. Only two
- C. All three
- D. None

Answer: A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is not correct:** Diwan-i-Kohi was established for **agricultural development and land reclamation** (not for military power).
- **Statement 2 is not correct:** The Iqtadari system was **not discontinued** during the rule of Firoz Shah Tughlaq; in fact, Firoz Shah Tughlaq made Iqtadari system hereditary and also made efforts to revive and further strengthen the Iqtadari system.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** **Firoz Shah Tughlaq** undertook efforts to improve irrigation infrastructure. He built and repaired canals, promoted water conservation techniques, and encouraged agriculture throughout the Sultanate.

Hence, option A is correct.